

DESIGN / EVIDENCE / QUALITY / TRAINING

Medical Devices English

Specify the need. Explain the evidence.
Keep the boundary clear.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For medical-device design, quality, regulatory, manufacturing, and clinical-training professionals.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight conversations across device development, postmarket information, and responsible product communication.

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A precise sentence protects the decision.

Device teams work across engineering, clinical, commercial, and regulatory perspectives. The same word can mean different things in different meetings: tested is not the same as validated, a complaint is not a confirmed cause, and a proposed pathway is not an authorization. These cases give you the language to make those distinctions without losing the practical next step.

Put the user beside the requirement

Name who will use the device, for which task, and in what environment. A broad adjective such as intuitive cannot replace a reviewable requirement or evidence from the relevant users.

"Which users and conditions does this requirement cover?"

Say what the evidence establishes

Identify the object, method, criteria, and result of a test. A passed specification check and evidence about intended use answer related but different questions.

"The output met this specification; the intended-user evaluation remains open."

Separate an observation from its explanation

Describe the event before naming a cause. Missing information is a follow-up task, not permission to replace uncertainty with a reassuring conclusion.

"The caller reported an interruption; the cause has not been established."

State whose decision it is

Routing a question, proposing a change, and authorizing release are different acts. Use a named review route and a visible status instead of implying that discussion has settled an approval.

"We can propose the change; the designated reviewer must assess it."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

Original fictional language practice, not device operating instructions or medical, legal, quality-system, or regulatory advice. US regulatory examples are identified as such; other jurisdictions differ. Use the current labeling, applicable requirements, trained personnel, and your organization's controlled procedures. No scenario authorizes patient care or product release.

What does easy to use mean?

A Read the situation

Turn an ambiguous design discussion into a scoped request for users, conditions, and measurable criteria.

Design engineer Mira and product lead Owen review a fictional monitoring-device brief. It says easy to use and suitable everywhere. The agreed initial audience is trained clinic staff, but an appended slide also mentions home caregivers. No home-use assessment is supplied. A proposed setup-time target of two minutes has not been reviewed or approved. Mira and Owen must distinguish the agreed scope, the proposed expansion, and the missing basis for a measurable design input.

PEOPLE / Mira: Design engineer | Owen: Product lead

CLARIFY WITHOUT DISMISSING THE NEED

A customer adjective can be a useful starting point. Acknowledge the concern behind it, then request the user, task, conditions, and evaluation basis. This sounds more collaborative than rejecting the adjective as meaningless, while still preventing an unsupported requirement from becoming an accepted fact.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who is the agreed initial audience?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Children using the device independently | B Trained clinic staff |
| C All home caregivers | D Every possible user without training |

2. What is the status of the two-minute target?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Proposed, not reviewed or approved | B Approved and already verified |
| C Required by a supplied regulation | D Demonstrated in a home-use study |

3. What additional evidence question follows from adding home caregivers to the brief?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Whether the existing clinic-user results have already established identical home performance | B Whether mentioning home use automatically adds it to the approved baseline |
| C Whether a numeric setup target alone removes the need to assess the new users | D Whether the new users, training, tasks, and home conditions support the proposed use |

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

user need

A requirement expressed from the perspective of the intended user.

IN USE capture a user need

design input

A specified requirement that guides device design and development.

IN USE define a design input

design output

A result of design work that can be checked against inputs.

IN USE review a design output

intended user

The person or user group the device is designed for.

IN USE identify intended users

intended use

The purpose for which a device is intended.

IN USE define the intended use

use environment

The physical and social setting in which a device is used.

IN USE characterize the use environment

user profile

Relevant characteristics of a defined user group.

IN USE develop a user profile

task analysis

Examination of the actions and decisions needed to perform a task.

IN USE conduct a task analysis

use scenario

A description of users performing tasks under specified conditions.

IN USE map a use scenario

design constraint

A limit that the design must satisfy.

IN USE document a design constraint

acceptance criterion

A specified condition used to decide whether a requirement is met.

IN USE establish acceptance criteria

measurable requirement

A requirement expressed so its fulfillment can be evaluated.

IN USE formulate a measurable requirement

Precision check

A proposed two-minute target is not an approved acceptance criterion. The team must identify what setup includes, who performs it, under which conditions, and why the target is appropriate before treating the number as a settled requirement.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

stakeholder

A person or group with a relevant interest in the product.

IN USE consult stakeholders

voice of the customer

Collected customer needs and expectations.

IN USE analyze the voice of the customer

requirements baseline

The agreed requirement set used as a reference for controlled work.

IN USE approve a requirements baseline

traceability

The ability to follow links between related records or requirements.

IN USE maintain requirements traceability

use limitation

A boundary on the conditions or purposes of use.

IN USE state a use limitation

ergonomics

Design attention to how people physically and cognitively interact with a product.

IN USE evaluate ergonomics

interface

The elements through which a user interacts with a device.

IN USE assess the user interface

workflow

The ordered activities through which work is completed.

IN USE observe the clinical workflow

design assumption

An unconfirmed premise influencing a design decision.

IN USE challenge a design assumption

scope expansion

An increase in the users, uses, or conditions covered by a project.

IN USE assess a scope expansion

change request

A documented proposal to alter an agreed item.

IN USE raise a change request

requirement owner

The person accountable for clarifying and maintaining a requirement.

IN USE assign a requirement owner

Precision check

Intended user, intended use, and use environment answer different questions. Trained clinic staff and home caregivers cannot be treated as interchangeable merely because the interface looks similar. A new audience may change the evidence needed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE NEED

"Ease of use matters; we need to define the task behind that phrase."

SEPARATE AN EXPANSION

"Home caregivers are a proposed additional user group."

CLARIFY THE TASK

"What exactly counts as setup in this requirement?"

ASK FOR THE BASIS

"What evidence supports that time limit?"

NAME THE CURRENT AUDIENCE

"The agreed initial users are trained clinic staff."

ASK ABOUT THE SETTING

"Which lighting, noise, and workflow conditions are in scope?"

MARK A PROPOSAL

"Two minutes is a candidate target, not an approved criterion."

KEEP NEEDS VISIBLE

"The requirement should address the user need rather than only our preferred feature."

Easy

An adjective that needs a defined task and evaluation basis.

Everywhere

A broad claim that can silently expand the intended environment.

Shall

Often marks a requirement; use it only with the document's agreed convention.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REQUEST TRACEABILITY

"Link this input to the need and the planned evaluation."

IDENTIFY AN ASSUMPTION

"We are assuming equivalent training, but that has not been established."

REQUEST A REVIEW

"The scope change needs review before it enters the baseline."

PRESERVE STATUS

"Keep the home-use item marked proposed in the meeting record."

CHALLENGE A BROAD CLAIM

"Suitable everywhere goes beyond the environments we have assessed."

DEFINE OWNERSHIP

"Who will resolve the user-profile question?"

DISTINGUISH OUTPUT

"A new screen layout is an output, not proof that the need is met."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"We will return with the defined task, conditions, and criterion basis."

Proposed

Signals that a target or change is not yet approved.

Baseline

The controlled reference, not every idea discussed in a meeting.

Trace

Connect the need, requirement, output, and evidence rather than repeat a label.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which revision preserves the current scope?

- A** Delete every reference to users and retain easy to use.
- B** Design for trained clinic staff; assess home-caregiver use as a proposed expansion.
- C** Design for all users because the interface is unchanged.
- D** State home use is validated because it appears on a slide.

2. Which statement accurately describes the time target?

- A** Two minutes is proposed; task boundaries and the criterion basis need review.
- B** Two minutes is approved because it is measurable.
- C** A numeric target needs no justification.
- D** The target proves suitability for home use.

3. What best distinguishes a need from an output?

- A** The need and the layout are identical records.
- B** Any output proves the need is satisfied.
- C** A user need must specify a preferred screen color.
- D** The need describes the user requirement; the screen layout is a design result.

4. Which meeting record is most accurate?

- A** Home use rejected permanently by this discussion.
- B** Setup performance failed a completed validation study.
- C** Clinic scope agreed; home-use assessment and setup criterion remain open.
- D** All environments approved and two-minute performance established.

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

What does easy to use mean?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

requirements baseline / acceptance criterion / traceability / requirement owner / user need / use environment / user profile / design input / design output / scope expansion

- 01 **Owen:** The customer summary says the device should be easy to use. I agree with that direction, but the design team says it cannot work from that sentence alone.
- 02 **Mira:** We can retain it as a ¹ _____. We still need the task, the people performing it, and the conditions that make the task difficult.
- 03 **Owen:** The initial audience is trained clinic staff. The latest slide adds home caregivers because sales sees a possible opportunity, although that group has not been assessed.
- 04 **Mira:** Then mark that as a ² _____. It is not simply another way of describing the audience already agreed in the brief.
- 05 **Owen:** Could we write setup within two minutes? It sounds clearer than easy to use, and the number would give engineering something definite to work toward.
- 06 **Mira:** It is a candidate ³ _____, not an approved one. We must define what setup includes and why two minutes is appropriate for those users.
- 07 **Owen:** That distinction matters. I do not want the meeting notes to turn a suggested number into a promise that the product has already been shown to meet.
- 08 **Mira:** We should also characterize the ⁴ _____. Lighting, interruptions, noise, and access to other staff can affect the task even when the screen stays unchanged.
- 09 **Owen:** The sales slide says suitable everywhere. We have not gathered evidence from homes, so I will remove that claim from the current product description.
- 10 **Mira:** Good. The ⁵ _____ should describe relevant training and capabilities. We cannot assume that clinic staff and home caregivers approach the same instruction in the same way.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Owen:** Engineering wants a simpler screen. Is that the requirement, or their proposed way to meet it? I want the brief to distinguish the two.
- 12 **Mira:** Treat the screen layout as a ⁶ _____. The input should express what must be achieved without presenting an untested layout as proof of success.
- 13 **Owen:** Then we need a record that connects the customer concern to a reviewable input and eventually to evidence. Otherwise the same question will return at every review.
- 14 **Mira:** That is ⁷ _____. Each link should make the reasoning visible, including which assumptions remain open and which version the team has agreed.
- 15 **Owen:** Who should resolve the setup definition? I can bring customer context, but I should not independently decide the engineering criterion or the relevant evaluation conditions.
- 16 **Mira:** Assign a ⁸ _____ to coordinate those contributions. The owner can bring the proposed wording and its basis back for the appropriate review.
- 17 **Owen:** I will separate the clinic requirement from the home-use proposal. The notes will say that the two-minute target remains unreviewed, with a named follow-up owner.
- 18 **Mira:** Keep both proposals outside the approved ⁹ _____ until the review is complete. Clear status now prevents later teams from treating a meeting idea as an established obligation.
- 19 **Owen:** I will keep easy to use as the customer concern and assign the setup-definition work. The home-use proposal and two-minute target remain open for review.
- 20 **Mira:** Exactly. A well-scoped ¹⁰ _____ will identify what the design must achieve. The evidence must then show whether the resulting device actually meets the relevant requirement.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. user need | 2. scope expansion | 3. acceptance criterion | 4. use environment | 5. user profile | 6. design output | 7. traceability | 8. requirement owner | 9. requirements baseline | 10. design input

A new setting, an open requirement

F Say it

A brief covers trained outpatient staff. A slide proposes home use. A ninety-second task target is suggested but has not been approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

baseline / criterion / expansion / clinic

Lead: "The agreed setting is the outpatient ¹ _____."

Engineer: "Home use is a proposed ² _____."

Lead: "Ninety seconds is not yet an approved ³ _____."

Engineer: "Keep the proposal separate from the current ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. clinic | 2. expansion | 3. criterion | 4. baseline

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the design-input discussion. Preserve trained clinic staff as the agreed audience and home caregivers as a proposal.
2. Swap roles. State the two-minute target as unapproved; identify setup boundaries and the basis still needed.
3. Read the corrected ninety-second transfer. Keep the outpatient baseline distinct from the proposed home expansion.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The hot surface is not the injury

A Read the situation

Separate a hazard, an exposure situation, possible harm, and the evidence for a risk-control claim.

Risk engineer Elena and mechanical lead Sam review a fictional enclosure-heating concern. The worksheet labels skin burn as the hazard and says low risk because no complaints have been received. The team has identified a potentially hot accessible surface, possible prolonged contact, and possible skin injury. No likelihood estimate or verified control result is supplied. An insulating cover is only a proposal. Their task is to correct the chain of reasoning without deciding that the device is safe.

PEOPLE / Elena: Risk engineer | Sam: Mechanical lead

CHALLENGE THE CHAIN, NOT THE PERSON

Risk meetings become more productive when colleagues identify the exact missing link. Ask whether a phrase names a source, an exposure, an outcome, or a control. A neutral classification question can reveal an important disagreement without turning the review into a personal argument.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which item is the potential source of harm?

- A The absence of complaints
- C The accessible hot surface

- B The unapproved meeting minutes
- D The possible skin burn

2. What is the status of the insulating cover?

- A Formally accepted as eliminating every risk
- C Proposed, with no verified control result supplied

- B A confirmed cause of the original heating
- D Implemented and proven effective

3. Why is low risk not established?

- A Possible harm and likelihood are identical concepts.
- C Every hot surface necessarily causes injury.

- B Neither a likelihood estimate nor a verified control result is supplied.
- D Any complaint-free device is automatically safe.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

hazard

A potential source of injury or other harm.

IN USE identify a hazard

harm

Injury or damage to health, property, or the environment.

IN USE describe possible harm

hazardous situation

Circumstances in which people or other protected things are exposed to a hazard.

IN USE identify a hazardous situation

sequence of events

The linked events that can lead to exposure and harm.

IN USE map the sequence of events

severity

The degree of possible harm.

IN USE assess harm severity

probability of harm

The likelihood that the specified harm will occur.

IN USE estimate the probability of harm

risk

The combination of the probability of harm and its severity.

IN USE evaluate a risk

risk analysis

Systematic identification of hazards and estimation of associated risks.

IN USE document the risk analysis

risk evaluation

Comparing estimated risk with established acceptability criteria.

IN USE perform a risk evaluation

risk control

A measure intended to reduce risk.

IN USE implement a risk control

residual risk

Risk remaining after risk-control measures have been implemented.

IN USE evaluate residual risk

risk acceptability

Whether risk meets the applicable acceptance criteria.

IN USE document risk acceptability

Precision check

Hazard, hazardous situation, and harm are not interchangeable. In this case, the potentially hot surface is the source; prolonged contact describes exposure; a burn is the possible injury. These distinctions clarify the analysis without supplying a likelihood estimate.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

protective measure

A safeguard intended to reduce exposure or its consequences.

IN USE assess a protective measure

inherent safety

Safety achieved through the design itself.

IN USE consider inherently safe design

information for safety

Warnings or instructions intended to support risk reduction.

IN USE review information for safety

benefit-risk analysis

Evaluation of relevant benefits against remaining risks.

IN USE document a benefit-risk analysis

risk management file

The organized records of risk-management activities and results.

IN USE maintain the risk management file

foreseeable misuse

Incorrect use that can reasonably be anticipated.

IN USE assess foreseeable misuse

normal condition

Operation without a fault being present.

IN USE assess normal conditions

fault condition

A state in which a component or function has failed.

IN USE examine fault conditions

control effectiveness

The demonstrated ability of a measure to reduce the identified risk.

IN USE verify control effectiveness

newly introduced risk

A risk created or changed by a design or control modification.

IN USE assess newly introduced risks

risk estimate

An assessment of harm probability and severity.

IN USE justify a risk estimate

objective evidence

Verifiable information supporting a conclusion.

IN USE obtain objective evidence

Precision check

No complaints received is not proof that the probability of harm is zero. A proposed cover is not yet an effective control. Assess implementation, effectiveness, and any risks introduced by the change through the applicable process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE SOURCE

"The accessible hot surface is the potential source of harm."

DESCRIBE THE OUTCOME

"A skin burn is the possible harm, not the source."

ASK FOR THE BASIS

"What evidence supports this likelihood estimate?"

MARK A PROPOSED CONTROL

"The cover is a candidate protective measure."

NAME THE EXPOSURE

"Prolonged contact is the exposure situation we need to examine."

SEPARATE TWO DIMENSIONS

"Severity and probability answer different questions."

AVOID FALSE REASSURANCE

"No complaints received does not establish zero risk."

REQUEST EVIDENCE

"We have not yet verified the control's effectiveness."

Potential

Identifies a possibility, not proof that an injury occurred.

May lead to

Connects events conditionally without asserting inevitability.

Severity

Describes how serious the harm could be, not how often it occurs.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE CHAIN

"Which sequence could lead from this condition to injury?"

ASSESS THE CHANGE

"Could the proposed cover introduce another risk?"

NAME THE CRITERION

"Which acceptability criteria are being applied?"

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"This review does not establish that every risk has been eliminated."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"The current record does not support the low-risk conclusion."

CLARIFY RESIDUAL RISK

"We cannot describe post-control risk before assessing the implemented measure."

KEEP THE RECORD LINKED

"Connect the analysis, control, verification, and review decision."

CLOSE WITH OWNERSHIP

"Assign the missing evidence to an owner before the next review."

Residual

Refers to what remains after implemented controls, not a proposed future state.

No evidence

Must not be shortened into evidence of no risk.

Effective

Requires support tied to the specific control and risk.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which chain is correctly labeled?

- A** Burn: hazard; hot surface: harm; no complaints: control.
- B** Prolonged contact: proof of injury; burn: probability.
- C** Cover proposal: verified control; burn: acceptance criterion.
- D** Hot surface: hazard; prolonged contact: exposure situation; burn: harm.

2. Which sentence accurately reports the complaint history?

- A** No complaints prove that contact cannot occur.
- B** No complaints prove that the cover works.
- C** No complaints make severity irrelevant.
- D** No complaints have been received; this alone does not establish the likelihood of harm.

3. Which review would support a control claim for the proposed insulating cover?

- A** Its proposed geometry, with residual risk accepted before implementation
- B** Its supplier description, with complaint absence substituted for control testing
- C** Its implementation, effect on contact risk, and any risk introduced by the change
- D** Its presence in the drawing, with effectiveness inferred from its protective name

4. Which conclusion fits the case?

- A** The device is proven safe for every use.
- B** A burn certainly occurred in every unit.
- C** The cover has already eliminated the hazard.
- D** Further evidence is needed before the stated risk conclusion is supported.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The hot surface is not the injury

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

severity / harm / newly introduced risk / objective evidence / hazardous situation / probability of harm / Residual risk / hazard / risk control / risk acceptability

- 01 **Sam:** The worksheet calls the skin burn a hazard and rates the issue low because we have no complaints. Can we close it with the proposed insulating cover?
- 02 **Elena:** Not from this record. The accessible hot surface is the ¹ _____. A skin burn describes a possible outcome, and the cover has not been evaluated.
- 03 **Sam:** I see the labeling problem. The surface could be accessible during use, and the scenario includes prolonged contact. We should keep those details in separate fields.
- 04 **Elena:** Yes. That contact describes a ² _____. It helps us explain how someone could be exposed instead of jumping directly from a component to an injury.
- 05 **Sam:** Then the burn belongs in the outcome field. We have not established that it happened, so the wording must not imply an observed patient event.
- 06 **Elena:** Correct. It is possible ³ _____. State the outcome conditionally and preserve the distinction between this design concern and a documented incident.
- 07 **Sam:** The team chose low because the complaint log is empty. That seems reassuring, but I cannot find any estimate showing how the exposure might occur.
- 08 **Elena:** We still need a justified ⁴ _____. An empty log does not establish zero occurrence, especially without understanding exposure, reporting, and the underlying evidence.
- 09 **Sam:** Should we remove the severity entry as well? It seems difficult to judge the risk while the likelihood information remains incomplete in this version.
- 10 **Elena:** Keep ⁵ _____ separate from likelihood. We need to describe the possible injury carefully; uncertainty in one dimension does not make the other dimension disappear.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Sam:** The cover remains attractive as an engineering proposal. I want to record it without giving the impression that it has already solved the issue.
- 12 **Elena:** Call it a proposed ⁶ _____. Identify what it is intended to change, the evidence needed, and who will review whether that change is effective.
- 13 **Sam:** Could the cover trap heat somewhere else? I want the review to consider that possibility as well as reducing contact with the hot surface.
- 14 **Elena:** Exactly. Assess any ⁷ _____. A measure can address one exposure while affecting another part of the design, so its consequences need a broader review.
- 15 **Sam:** The draft already says residual risk acceptable. That sounds premature when the proposed measure has not been implemented or assessed against the relevant criteria.
- 16 **Elena:** It is premature. ⁸ _____ refers to what remains after controls. We should not describe a future condition as though its implementation and effectiveness were already established.
- 17 **Sam:** I will change the status to evidence incomplete and retain the proposed cover as an action for engineering review. We also need the criterion behind any acceptance decision.
- 18 **Elena:** Yes, document the applicable ⁹ _____ criteria. The reviewer needs the reasoning and evidence, not simply a low label attached to an unfinished analysis.
- 19 **Sam:** I will separate the hot surface, prolonged contact, and possible burn in the record. Send me the evidence needed before we can judge the proposed cover.
- 20 **Elena:** That gives the next review useful ¹⁰ _____ to request and evaluate. We can make progress on the concern without converting a proposal into a completed safety conclusion.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. hazard | 2. hazardous situation | 3. harm | 4. probability of harm | 5. severity | 6. risk control | 7. newly introduced risk | 8. Residual risk | 9. risk acceptability | 10. objective evidence

Proposal is not verification

F Say it

A fictional handle may have a sharp edge. Hand contact could cause a cut. A rounded redesign is proposed but has not been evaluated.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

hazard / evidence / harm / control

Engineer: "The sharp edge is the potential ¹ _____."

Reviewer: "The cut is the possible ² _____."

Engineer: "The rounded redesign is a proposed ³ _____."

Reviewer: "Its effectiveness still requires ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. hazard | 2. harm | 3. control | 4. evidence

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the risk review. Name the hot surface, prolonged contact, and possible burn as source, exposure, and harm.
2. Swap roles. Keep the cover proposed and its effect unverified; do not use complaint absence as a probability estimate.
3. Read the corrected sharp-edge transfer. Distinguish the redesign proposal from evidence of control effectiveness.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Twelve checks passed, one evaluation still open

A Read the situation

Report completed specification checks without implying that intended-use evaluation or release authorization is complete.

Verification lead Arun and development manager Beth review the status of a fictional device. All twelve planned specification checks in the current package passed. The separate intended-user evaluation has not started. The slide nevertheless says validation complete and ready for release. No release authorization is supplied. A review meeting is scheduled tomorrow. Arun and Beth must present the completed evidence, the unperformed work, and the decision still required without treating the meeting itself as approval.

PEOPLE / Arun: Verification lead | Beth: Development manager

USE COMPLETE WITH AN OBJECT

A status update can be confident and narrow at the same time. Say which package is complete and which criterion it addresses. Replacing a global green status with separate evidence and decision lines helps colleagues see progress without confusing a finished test with a finished product.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has passed?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A The final release authorization | B All future product configurations |
| C Twelve planned specification checks in the current package | D Every intended-user evaluation |

2. What has not started?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A The scheduled review meeting yesterday | B The separate intended-user evaluation |
| C Every specification check | D The project itself |

3. What does tomorrow's meeting establish now?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A That all open actions are closed | B Only that a review is scheduled |
| C That release is authorized | D That intended use has been validated |

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

verification

Confirmation with evidence that specified requirements have been fulfilled.

IN USE complete design verification

validation

Confirmation with evidence that requirements for an intended use are fulfilled.

IN USE plan design validation

design review

A systematic evaluation of design progress, evidence, and issues.

IN USE hold a design review

test protocol

A documented plan describing how a test will be performed and assessed.

IN USE approve a test protocol

test report

A record of test execution, results, and conclusions.

IN USE review a test report

test article

The item or configuration used in a test.

IN USE identify the test article

configuration

The defined arrangement and versions of a product's elements.

IN USE control the test configuration

requirement coverage

The extent to which requirements are addressed by specified evidence.

IN USE assess requirement coverage

traceability matrix

A structured table linking requirements to related evidence.

IN USE update the traceability matrix

test deviation

A departure from the planned test method or conditions.

IN USE assess a test deviation

unresolved anomaly

An observed irregularity whose significance or resolution remains open.

IN USE review unresolved anomalies

acceptance result

The recorded outcome against a specified acceptance criterion.

IN USE document the acceptance result

Precision check

The twelve checks support the specified requirements they address, in the tested configuration. They do not automatically cover every user need, later version, or intended-use condition. Report completion at the level supported by the actual evidence.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

representativeness

How well an item or setting reflects the intended evaluated population or use.

IN USE justify representativeness

simulated use

Evaluation under conditions designed to represent actual use.

IN USE define simulated-use conditions

review action

A task assigned as a result of a review.

IN USE track review actions

action closure

Documented completion and acceptance of an assigned task.

IN USE verify action closure

release authorization

A formal decision permitting a product or version to be released.

IN USE obtain release authorization

design transfer

Translation of the design into production specifications and processes.

IN USE review design transfer

document control

Management of document versions, approval, and availability.

IN USE maintain document control

change impact

The consequences of a proposed or implemented alteration.

IN USE assess change impact

regression testing

Rechecking affected behavior after a change.

IN USE plan regression testing

evidence package

The organized records supporting a specific conclusion or decision.

IN USE assemble the evidence package

review quorum

The required participation for a particular review under its procedure.

IN USE confirm the review quorum

decision record

A documented conclusion, rationale, and associated conditions.

IN USE maintain a decision record

Precision check

A scheduled design review is not a completed decision. A review action is not closed merely because someone accepts ownership. Distinguish the test result, the remaining evaluation, the review conclusion, and the authorized release decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

STATE THE COMPLETED WORK

"All twelve checks in this specification package passed."

NAME THE OPEN EVALUATION

"The intended-user evaluation has not started."

REQUEST THE LINK

"Which requirement does this result address?"

SEPARATE THE DECISION

"A passed test package is not release authorization."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"That result applies to the tested configuration and covered requirements."

CORRECT THE STATUS

"Replace validation complete with specification checks complete."

ASK ABOUT DEVIATIONS

"Were any departures from the protocol assessed and documented?"

DESCRIBE THE MEETING

"The review is scheduled; its conclusion is not yet available."

Complete

State exactly which task, package, or decision is complete.

Passed

Applies to specified criteria under stated test conditions.

Representative

Needs a basis; visual similarity alone is not enough.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

KEEP ACTIONS VISIBLE

"Assign an owner and closure evidence for each open item."

REQUEST THE RATIONALE

"What supports the representativeness of this test article?"

AVOID A GLOBAL CLAIM

"We have not demonstrated every intended-use requirement."

RECORD THE CONCLUSION

"Capture the actual decision and any conditions after the review."

CHECK THE VERSION

"Confirm that the report covers the version presented for review."

ASSESS A CHANGE

"A later modification needs an impact assessment before relying on these results."

CLARIFY THE HANDOFF

"The review package should show completed evidence and unresolved work separately."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Ready for review does not mean ready for release."

Pending

Identifies unresolved work without implying failure or success.

Authorized

Describes a decision by the responsible authority, not general enthusiasm.

Covered

Means linked evidence exists for the named requirement, not for every possible claim.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which slide heading is supported?

- A** Twelve specification checks passed; intended-user evaluation not started.
- B** Validation complete and product released.
- C** All user needs proven by twelve engineering checks.
- D** Review completed because tomorrow is booked.

2. A software revision follows the tests. What wording is best?

- A** Any change makes all historical evidence false.
- B** A new version number alone proves validation.
- C** Assess the change before assuming the earlier results cover the new version.
- D** Earlier results automatically cover every future revision.

3. A reviewer accepts ownership of an open test deviation. Which status can be recorded at that point?

- A** Release approved because the deviation has entered the action log
- B** Owner assigned; required assessment, completion evidence, and acceptance still outstanding
- C** Deviation accepted as harmless because a reviewer now owns it
- D** Action closed because responsibility is no longer unassigned

4. Which conclusion may Beth report before the review?

- A** The review has approved release.
- B** Intended-use validation succeeded without being performed.
- C** No further decision is required.
- D** The evidence package is ready for the scheduled review, with the remaining work identified.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Twelve checks passed, one evaluation still open

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

configuration / validation / decision record / test deviation / Action closure / Release authorization / verification / requirement coverage / change impact / evidence package

- 01 **Beth:** The dashboard says validation complete because all twelve checks passed. Before tomorrow's review, I want to be sure that headline means what the team thinks it means.
- 02 **Arun:** The completed work is ¹ _____ against the specifications in this package. The separate intended-user evaluation has not started, so the headline combines two different claims.
- 03 **Beth:** The test result is still good progress. We should not hide it, but we should identify what those twelve checks actually cover and what remains unperformed.
- 04 **Arun:** Exactly. We cannot mark ² _____ complete from these checks alone. The report should distinguish specification fulfillment from the evidence still needed about the intended use.
- 05 **Beth:** Can we say every requirement passed? That would be shorter, although I suspect the word every would extend the claim beyond this particular set of checks.
- 06 **Arun:** Show the ³ _____ instead. Each result needs a clear link to its requirement, and any uncovered requirements must remain visible in the review package.
- 07 **Beth:** I also noticed that the report refers to the earlier software build. The team discussed a revision, but I do not know whether it has been implemented.
- 08 **Arun:** We must confirm the ⁴ _____. Evidence belongs to the item actually tested; a discussion about a later build cannot silently extend the report to that version.
- 09 **Beth:** If the revision goes ahead, which test conclusions might it affect? Please flag that question now so the release review does not inherit mismatched versions.
- 10 **Arun:** That calls for a ⁵ _____ assessment. We should not assume that every old result becomes invalid, or that every result automatically remains sufficient.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Beth:** The dashboard also says ready for release. I intended ready for tomorrow's meeting, but I can see that those are not interchangeable status descriptions.
- 12 **Arun:** Correct. ⁶ _____ is a separate decision. We have not been given that authorization, and scheduling a review does not establish its future outcome.
- 13 **Beth:** I will change the status to ready for review and put the unperformed intended-user evaluation beside the completed specification package. That should prevent a misleading green summary.
- 14 **Arun:** Include the ⁷ _____, not just the totals. Reviewers need the reports, relevant versions, criteria, and any departures from the planned method.
- 15 **Beth:** There was one departure noted during execution. I do not want to describe it as a failed requirement if that is not what happened.
- 16 **Arun:** Call it a ⁸ _____ and reference its assessment. The record should explain its significance and disposition without treating the label itself as a pass or failure.
- 17 **Beth:** Tomorrow, each unresolved item needs an owner. But the minutes should not show those items as closed simply because someone agrees to take responsibility.
- 18 **Arun:** Yes. ⁹ _____ needs the required evidence and acceptance. Ownership makes follow-up possible; it does not demonstrate that the remaining task has already been completed.
- 19 **Beth:** I will separate the twelve passed checks from the unstarted user evaluation. Please confirm the tested build and keep release authorization off the slide until it exists.
- 20 **Arun:** After the meeting, add the actual ¹⁰ _____ and its conditions. That keeps completed testing, open evaluation, review conclusions, and release status distinct throughout the handoff.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. verification | 2. validation | 3. requirement coverage | 4. configuration | 5. change impact | 6. Release authorization | 7. evidence package | 8. test deviation | 9. Action closure | 10. decision record

A review date is not a decision

F Say it

Six specification checks passed on version B. The intended-use evaluation is pending, and a review is booked for Friday. No release decision has been made.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

B / review / authorized / pending

Lead: "Six checks passed on version ¹ _____."

Engineer: "The intended-use evaluation remains ² _____."

Lead: "Friday is the scheduled ³ _____."

Engineer: "Release has not been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. B | 2. pending | 3. review | 4. authorized

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the review exchange. State twelve passed specification checks and the intended-user evaluation not started.
2. Swap roles. Distinguish the tested configuration, tomorrow's review, and the release decision still unmade.
3. Read the corrected version-B transfer. Friday remains a review date, not evidence that release is authorized.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three participants read the label differently

04

A Read the situation

Report observed use difficulties neutrally and distinguish exploratory findings from validation or population-level rates.

Human-factors specialist Laila and interface designer Victor review a formative study of a fictional device label. Three of eight participants selected the wrong status label during a simulated task. The draft summary calls them careless and concludes that a larger font will solve the problem. No revised label has been tested, and the study does not establish a population error rate. Laila and Victor must preserve the observation, investigate the interface, and describe the proposed revision without declaring success.

PEOPLE / Laila: Human-factors specialist | Victor: Interface designer

DESCRIBE THE INTERACTION BEFORE JUDGING IT

Careless assigns a personal explanation that an observation may not support. Describe what participants saw, did, and said, then examine the task and interface. Neutral language can be more demanding than blame because it requires the team to specify evidence for its explanation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What was observed?

- A** Every user failed in actual clinical use.
- B** A larger font eliminated the difficulty.
- C** A population-wide error rate was established.
- D** Three of eight participants selected the wrong status label in the simulated task.

2. Which wording adds a cause not established by the three wrong selections?

- A** Three participants selected the wrong status label in the task.
- B** The proposed larger-font version has not been evaluated.
- C** The reason for the selections remains under investigation.
- D** Participants selected incorrectly because they were careless.

3. What is the status of the larger font?

- A** An untested proposed revision
- B** A validated solution
- C** An approved universal corrective action
- D** Proof that no other interface issue exists

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

human factors

Study and application of how people interact with systems and products.

IN USE apply human-factors principles

usability engineering

A structured approach to evaluating and improving user interaction.

IN USE conduct usability engineering

formative evaluation

An exploratory assessment used to inform design development.

IN USE run a formative evaluation

summative evaluation

An assessment of a sufficiently developed design against defined evaluation goals.

IN USE plan a summative evaluation

human-factors validation

Evaluation of intended users performing relevant tasks under representative conditions.

IN USE plan human-factors validation

critical task

A task whose error or omission could seriously harm a patient or user, including compromised care.

IN USE identify critical tasks

use error

An action or omission producing a result different from that intended or expected.

IN USE analyze a use error

close call

A situation in which a problem nearly occurs but is avoided.

IN USE document a close call

use difficulty

Observed trouble completing or understanding a task.

IN USE record a use difficulty

participant

A person taking part in a study.

IN USE recruit representative participants

moderator

The person guiding a study session under its protocol.

IN USE brief the moderator

prompting

Assistance that may influence a participant's performance.

IN USE document moderator prompting

Precision check

Three of eight is 37.5% of this study group, not an established error rate for the user population. Report the count and study context. A formative finding can identify a design concern without providing a final validation conclusion.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

task success

Completion of a defined task under stated evaluation criteria.

IN USE define task success

observation note

A factual record of behavior or events during a study.

IN USE write an observation note

root-cause analysis

Investigation of underlying contributors to an observed problem.

IN USE conduct root-cause analysis

mental model

A user's understanding of how a system works.

IN USE explore the user's mental model

affordance

A feature suggesting how an object or control can be used.

IN USE assess interface affordances

label comprehension

Understanding the meaning conveyed by a label.

IN USE evaluate label comprehension

visual hierarchy

The arrangement that makes some information more prominent than other information.

IN USE improve the visual hierarchy

legibility

How readily individual text or symbols can be distinguished.

IN USE assess label legibility

cognitive load

The mental effort needed to process information and perform a task.

IN USE reduce cognitive load

training decay

Loss of retained training knowledge or skill over time.

IN USE consider training decay

representative sample

A participant group suited to the intended study population and question.

IN USE justify the representative sample

design iteration

A revised version created through successive development cycles.

IN USE evaluate a design iteration

Precision check

Legibility asks whether text can be distinguished; comprehension asks whether its meaning is understood. Increasing font size may affect one without resolving the other. A proposed revision needs evaluation rather than a sentence declaring it successful.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

REPORT THE OBSERVATION

"Three of eight participants selected the wrong status label."

REMOVE BLAME

"The notes do not establish that the participants were careless."

ASK ABOUT WORDING

"Did participants distinguish the meanings of the two labels?"

CHECK ASSISTANCE

"Record whether the moderator prompted the participant."

PRESERVE THE CONTEXT

"This occurred in the simulated task used in the formative study."

SEPARATE BEHAVIOR FROM CAUSE

"The selection is observed; the reason still needs investigation."

ASK ABOUT VISIBILITY

"Was the relevant text readily legible under the study conditions?"

BOUND THE PERCENTAGE

"That percentage describes this study group, not the user population."

Observed

Identifies what was recorded rather than why it happened.

Careless

Assigns blame that the evidence may not support.

Formative

Describes work intended to inform design development.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

MARK THE REVISION

"A larger font is proposed but has not been evaluated."

COMPARE EXPLANATIONS

"Font size, wording, and hierarchy are different possible contributors."

CLARIFY TASK RISK

"Assess the task's safety significance through the appropriate process."

REQUEST A SCOPED FOLLOW-UP

"Evaluate the revised label against the specific difficulty observed."

AVOID A SUCCESS CLAIM

"We cannot yet say the change resolves the problem."

KEEP EVIDENCE INTACT

"Retain the observation notes when revising the summary."

NAME THE EVALUATION STAGE

"These formative findings inform development; they are not a completed validation claim."

CLOSE THE REPORT

"State the finding, the open explanation, and the next evaluation separately."

Resolves

Claims an outcome that needs evidence from the revised design.

Legible

Readable at the text or symbol level, not necessarily understood.

Representative

Depends on users, tasks, and conditions, not only participant count.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary is most accurate?

- A** Three careless participants invalidate the study.
- B** Larger text has already solved the issue.
- C** Three of eight participants selected the wrong label in the formative simulated task.
- D** The product has a proven 37.5% population error rate.

2. A participant can read both labels aloud but confuses their meanings. Which issue is most directly suggested?

- A** Proven mechanical failure
- B** Label comprehension
- C** Inability to distinguish printed characters alone
- D** Confirmed training decay in every user

3. How should assistance during a task be reported?

- A** Assume the moderator could not influence performance.
- B** Document the prompting rather than presenting assisted success as unassisted performance.
- C** Remove the assistance from the notes if the task was completed.
- D** Treat any prompted completion as evidence that no difficulty existed.

4. Which next-status sentence fits the facts?

- A** The revised label passed validation.
- B** The study proves that only font size matters.
- C** All intended users will now select correctly.
- D** The larger-font revision is proposed; its effect on the observed difficulty remains untested.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

Three participants read the label differently

04

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

human-factors validation / formative evaluation / Legibility / root-cause analysis / design iteration / prompting / visual hierarchy / critical task / label comprehension / observation note

- 01 **Victor:** Three of the eight participants chose the wrong status label. The draft calls them careless. That is not something I can establish from watching the selection.
- 02 **Laila:** Then keep the ¹ _____ factual: which label, which task, and what happened. Remove the character judgment without losing the actual difficulty.
- 03 **Victor:** Would thirty-seven point five percent sound more precise in the headline? I worry the count looks small, even though the issue may matter.
- 04 **Laila:** Identify the ² _____ and keep three of eight visible. The percentage describes these participants; it is not an estimated population error rate.
- 05 **Victor:** The team wants a larger font. That is easy to implement, but I cannot yet say that small characters caused all three wrong selections.
- 06 **Laila:** ³ _____ is one question. We also need to examine whether the words distinguish the two states clearly in the task context.
- 07 **Victor:** One person read both labels aloud accurately and still selected the wrong status. Larger letters would not necessarily address that person's interpretation.
- 08 **Laila:** That observation concerns ⁴ _____. Keep it separate from a claim that the text could not be read, and do not assume every participant had the same problem.
- 09 **Victor:** Another person finished after the moderator asked a follow-up question. The results table currently says success, with no note about the intervention.
- 10 **Laila:** Record the ⁵ _____. We need to see how completion was achieved; assisted success should not silently become unassisted task performance.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Victor:** What about placing the status higher on the screen? That changes where attention goes, rather than only changing the text size.
- 12 **Laila:** It is a ⁶ _____ proposal. We can evaluate it alongside wording, but neither idea is a demonstrated solution yet.
- 13 **Victor:** I will stop calling the larger font a fix. The revised label has not been tested, and we may need a different approach.
- 14 **Laila:** Call it a proposed ⁷ _____. Link it to the observed difficulty and keep the follow-up result open rather than writing success in advance.
- 15 **Victor:** The project lead also asks whether a wrong selection makes this a critical task. Three errors alone do not answer the safety question, do they?
- 16 **Laila:** No. Designating a ⁸ _____ depends on potential consequences, including compromised care. The relevant risk assessment must address that, not just the number of selections.
- 17 **Victor:** Then I should not describe this as our final usability validation either. We used the session to find weaknesses while the interface was still developing.
- 18 **Laila:** Correct. Completed ⁹ _____ is not established by a formative session and an untested revision. State the evaluation stage and conditions clearly.
- 19 **Victor:** I will retain the three-of-eight count, the reading-versus-meaning observation, and the assisted completion. Proposed changes will sit in a separate section.
- 20 **Laila:** That gives the ¹⁰ _____ useful evidence. We can investigate the difficulty without blaming participants or promising that one easy design change resolves it.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. observation note | 2. formative evaluation | 3. Legibility | 4. label comprehension | 5. prompting | 6. visual hierarchy | 7. design iteration | 8. critical task | 9. human-factors validation | 10. root-cause analysis

Readable is not necessarily understood

F Say it

Two of ten participants read a label accurately but misunderstand its meaning in a formative session. Revised wording is proposed and has not been tested.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

untested / meaning / session / resolved

Researcher: "Two of ten had difficulty with the label's ¹ _____."

Designer: "This is an observation from a formative ² _____."

Researcher: "The new wording remains ³ _____."

Designer: "We cannot yet claim the difficulty is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. meaning | 2. session | 3. untested | 4. resolved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the formative-study discussion. State three of eight wrong selections and distinguish behavior from an inferred cause.
2. Swap roles. Contrast readable text with understood meaning and assisted completion with unassisted performance.
3. Read the corrected two-of-ten transfer. Keep the revised wording untested and the comprehension issue unresolved.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A route under review is not a clearance

A Read the situation

Distinguish a proposed US submission pathway, supporting evidence, and an actual regulatory decision.

05

Regulatory specialist Inez and commercial director Caleb review a fictional US launch plan. The team is evaluating a possible 510(k) pathway and has identified a candidate predicate, but its suitability is still under review. No submission has been filed and no FDA decision exists. A sales slide says FDA approved and promises an October launch. Inez must correct both the status and the certainty of the timeline while preserving a clear planning discussion.

PEOPLE / Inez: Regulatory specialist | Caleb: Commercial director

CORRECT STATUS WITHOUT INVENTING THE OPPOSITE

An unsupported approval claim should be replaced with the actual status, not with a prediction that the device will fail. Separate the pathway assessment, evidence plan, submission, review, and decision. This gives commercial colleagues information they can use without a guarantee the team cannot make.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the current pathway status?

- A** Every regulatory requirement has been waived.
- C** FDA has granted a PMA approval.

- B** A possible 510(k) route is being evaluated.
- D** A 510(k) clearance has been issued.

2. What is known about the predicate?

- A** Its suitability has been conclusively accepted by FDA.
- C** No comparison is needed because the devices look similar.

- B** It automatically covers every proposed use.
- D** A candidate has been identified, but suitability remains under review.

3. Why is the October launch promise unsupported?

- A** October launches are never possible.
- C** All 510(k) reviews are legally guaranteed to fail.

- B** No filing or regulatory decision exists, and the pathway assessment is incomplete.
- D** The product has already been prohibited permanently.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

regulatory pathway

The applicable route for obtaining a required regulatory decision.

IN USE assess the regulatory pathway

device classification

A regulatory category reflecting the device type and applicable controls.

IN USE confirm device classification

product code

A code used by FDA to identify a device type.

IN USE verify the product code

510(k)

A US premarket notification seeking a substantial-equivalence determination.

IN USE prepare a 510(k)

predicate device

A legally marketed comparator used in a 510(k) assessment.

IN USE assess a candidate predicate

substantial equivalence

The comparative regulatory determination central to a 510(k) decision.

IN USE support substantial equivalence

De Novo request

A US request for risk-based classification of a novel eligible device.

IN USE assess a De Novo request

premarket approval

The US PMA pathway requiring an independent safety-and-effectiveness demonstration.

IN USE prepare a premarket approval application

clearance

A favorable 510(k) determination permitting marketing within its scope.

IN USE obtain 510(k) clearance

approval

A formal favorable decision under an applicable approval pathway.

IN USE distinguish approval from clearance

indications for use

The specific purposes and population described for a device's use.

IN USE define indications for use

technological characteristics

Design and operating features relevant to a regulatory comparison.

IN USE compare technological characteristics

Precision check

For a US 510(k), clearance is the relevant decision term; it should not be casually called PMA approval. A candidate predicate, a pathway assessment, a submitted file, and an agency decision are four different statuses.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

general controls

Baseline regulatory controls applicable to medical devices.

IN USE comply with general controls

special controls

Additional controls applicable to certain device types.

IN USE identify special controls

submission dossier

The organized documents and evidence submitted for regulatory review.

IN USE assemble a submission dossier

evidence plan

A plan for generating and organizing support for specified claims.

IN USE develop an evidence plan

regulatory strategy

A coordinated approach to regulatory requirements and decisions.

IN USE align the regulatory strategy

pre-submission interaction

A planned exchange with FDA before a later submission.

IN USE request a pre-submission interaction

review question

A request for clarification or evidence during review.

IN USE address a review question

deficiency

A shortcoming identified in the submitted information.

IN USE respond to a deficiency

response package

Documents addressing specified reviewer questions or deficiencies.

IN USE compile a response package

marketing authorization

The applicable permission to market a device within a defined scope.

IN USE confirm marketing authorization

regulatory dependency

An unresolved regulatory matter affecting another planned step.

IN USE identify a regulatory dependency

launch assumption

A planning premise underlying the proposed market-entry date.

IN USE qualify a launch assumption

Precision check

A proposed pathway does not determine the outcome or guarantee a date. The actual device, claims, classification, and evidence matter. These fictional facts do not establish eligibility for 510(k), De Novo, PMA, or an exemption.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE CURRENT STAGE

"We are evaluating a possible 510(k) pathway."

CORRECT THE DECISION CLAIM

"No FDA decision has been issued for this device."

USE THE RIGHT TERM

"A favorable 510(k) determination is clearance, not PMA approval."

CLARIFY THE CLAIM

"The proposed indications must be consistent across the evidence and materials."

QUALIFY THE COMPARATOR

"The predicate candidate remains under review."

NAME THE MISSING FILING

"The submission has not yet been filed."

SEPARATE SIMILARITY FROM EVIDENCE

"Similar appearance alone does not establish substantial equivalence."

BOUND THE TIMELINE

"October is a planning assumption, not an authorized launch date."

Candidate

Identifies an option being assessed rather than an accepted comparator.

Filed

Reports submission, not a favorable review outcome.

Cleared

Use for an actual favorable 510(k) determination within its scope.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

IDENTIFY DEPENDENCIES

"The pathway assessment and evidence requirements remain unresolved."

REQUEST SPECIALIST REVIEW

"Regulatory needs to assess the proposed use and comparison."

ALIGN THE SLIDE

"Replace FDA approved with the actual development status."

NAME THE NEXT DELIVERABLE

"The next step is the pathway assessment, not a launch announcement."

AVOID PREDICTING REJECTION

"An open assessment does not mean the device has been rejected."

DESCRIBE AN INTERACTION

"A pre-submission discussion is not a marketing authorization."

KEEP DECISIONS TRACEABLE

"Use the exact decision and scope when an authorization exists."

CLOSE THE PLANNING DISCUSSION

"We can plan around dependencies without promising the agency's decision."

Approved

Do not use as a generic synonym for every regulatory interaction.

Expected

A forecast needs assumptions and should not sound like a guarantee.

Under review

Specify whether the review is internal or by the agency.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which sales-slide correction matches the case?

- A** PMA rejected because the team discussed 510(k).
- B** Possible 510(k) pathway under internal assessment; no submission or FDA decision yet.
- C** FDA approved because a predicate was found.
- D** FDA clearance guaranteed by October.

2. Which statement about the candidate predicate is accurate?

- A** Any similar-looking marketed product guarantees substantial equivalence.
- B** A candidate predicate grants marketing permission.
- C** A product code alone proves every proposed indication is supported.
- D** Identification begins the assessment; suitability and the comparative evidence still need review.

3. Which October-launch note preserves the current regulatory status?

- A** Confirmed market-entry date once the candidate predicate is listed in the slide
- B** Agency review deadline beginning when the internal pathway discussion started
- C** Internal planning target; pathway and predicate still under assessment, with no filing or decision
- D** Expected FDA clearance date because the commercial team has approved the target

4. What does a pre-submission interaction establish by itself?

- A** A guaranteed review outcome
- B** Permission for every proposed claim
- C** An opportunity for feedback, not marketing authorization
- D** A final 510(k) clearance

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

A route under review is not a clearance

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

predicate device / indications for use / pre-submission interaction / launch assumption / substantial equivalence / submission dossier / regulatory pathway / marketing authorization / clearance / regulatory strategy

- 01 **Caleb:** The launch slide says FDA approved and shows October as the launch month. I need to understand whether those statements reflect an actual decision or our working plan.
- 02 **Inez:** Neither is an authorization. We are still assessing the ¹ _____, including whether a 510(k) route is appropriate for the proposed device and its claims.
- 03 **Caleb:** The team found a marketed device that looks similar. I took that as confirmation that the route was settled, but the comparison may not be that simple.
- 04 **Inez:** It is a candidate ² _____. Its suitability remains under review; visual similarity alone does not establish the regulatory comparison needed for the proposed use.
- 05 **Caleb:** What should the commercial team understand about that comparison? I want the next discussion to focus on the evidence rather than repeat the same assumption.
- 06 **Inez:** The relevant determination is ³ _____. The proposed use and technological characteristics matter, and the evidence must support the actual comparison rather than a convenient headline.
- 07 **Caleb:** Nothing has been filed, correct? Then under review is too vague; sales could read that as an FDA review already underway.
- 08 **Inez:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ is not filed. Say internal pathway assessment, and keep that separate from any future agency review or decision.
- 09 **Caleb:** If the team eventually follows the 510(k) route successfully, should the slide say approved? That term is common in sales conversations, but I want it to be accurate.
- 10 **Inez:** Use ⁵ _____ for the actual favorable 510(k) determination. Do not borrow the language of a different pathway or imply a decision before one exists.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Caleb:** Could a different route still be needed? I do not want the revised slide to make the 510(k) plan sound irrevocable while the assessment is incomplete.
- 12 **Inez:** Yes, keep the ⁶ _____ provisional where appropriate. This discussion does not determine eligibility for another route, and we should not guess the outcome from limited facts.
- 13 **Caleb:** The product team also wants broader wording about who can use the device. That seems connected to the pathway work, not just to marketing style.
- 14 **Inez:** It is. The ⁷ _____ must be clear and consistent. A broader statement can change the claim being assessed and the evidence needed to support it.
- 15 **Caleb:** Then October should be shown as an internal target with conditions. We cannot treat it as an agency commitment when neither the pathway nor the evidence package is settled.
- 16 **Inez:** Call it a ⁸ _____ and show the dependencies. That allows planning without making a promise about a regulatory decision that has not occurred.
- 17 **Caleb:** We may seek feedback before filing. I will make sure the team does not describe a discussion with the agency as permission to market the device.
- 18 **Inez:** Correct. A ⁹ _____ is not the marketing decision. Any feedback and its scope should be recorded accurately without converting it into blanket approval.
- 19 **Caleb:** I will remove FDA approved and mark October as conditional. Send me the pathway-assessment milestone and its dependencies for the planning slide.
- 20 **Inez:** Good. The communication must distinguish planning from ¹⁰ _____. We can describe the work confidently while leaving the unresolved regulatory decision exactly where it belongs.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. regulatory pathway | 2. predicate device | 3. substantial equivalence | 4. submission dossier | 5. clearance | 6. regulatory strategy | 7. indications for use | 8. launch assumption | 9. pre-submission interaction | 10. marketing authorization

A filing is not a favorable decision

F Say it

A fictional US 510(k) submission has been filed. Review is ongoing, and no decision has been issued. The commercial team has an internal target date.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ongoing / assumption / filed / clearance

Lead: "The submission has been ¹ _____."

Specialist: "The agency's review remains ² _____."

Lead: "No 510(k) ³ _____ has been issued."

Specialist: "The target date is a planning ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. filed | 2. ongoing | 3. clearance | 4. assumption

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the launch discussion. Distinguish pathway assessment, candidate predicate, filing, and an actual agency decision.
2. Swap roles. Use clearance for the 510(k) outcome and describe October as an internal conditional target.
3. Read the corrected filing transfer. A filed submission with ongoing review is not a granted clearance.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Incomplete information still needs a handoff

A Read the situation

Capture a complaint accurately, route missing information promptly, and distinguish counts from rates and reports from causation.

06

Complaint specialist Nora and service lead Dev review a caller's report that a fictional monitor unexpectedly stopped displaying. The event date, device identifier, and patient outcome are not yet known. The call was received today at 14:10. Dev proposes waiting for every field before routing it. A separate dashboard shows eight complaints this quarter versus four last quarter, without use-volume data. Nora must preserve the unknowns, arrange the required internal review, and prevent either dataset from implying an unsupported conclusion.

PEOPLE / Nora: Complaint specialist | Dev: Service lead

UNKNOWN IS A USEFUL STATUS

A missing field can be stated clearly without sounding evasive. Say what was reported, what is unknown, who is seeking it, and where the information has been routed. This supports timely review while avoiding a false conclusion that no injury or device problem occurred.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which time is known?

- A** The time FDA issued a decision
- B** The call-receipt time, 14:10 today
- C** The exact event time
- D** The time of a confirmed patient injury

2. What is known about patient outcome?

- A** No injury occurred.
- B** A serious injury is confirmed.
- C** The device definitely caused harm.
- D** It is not yet known.

3. What does eight versus four establish?

- A** The product caused twice as many injuries.
- B** Reporting behavior stayed identical.
- C** The complaint count doubled, but no rate can be calculated from the supplied data.
- D** The rate per use doubled.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

complaint

A reported concern about a device's quality, performance, safety, or related service.

IN USE capture a complaint

adverse event

An unfavorable occurrence that may require assessment of its relationship to a device.

IN USE assess an adverse event

malfunction

A failure to perform as intended or meet relevant performance specifications.

IN USE investigate a reported malfunction

Medical Device Reporting

The US system for reporting specified device events under applicable requirements.

IN USE assess Medical Device Reporting obligations

reportability

Whether an event meets applicable reporting requirements.

IN USE assess reportability

initial reporter

The person or organization first providing event information.

IN USE contact the initial reporter

awareness date

The date relevant event information becomes known for the applicable assessment.

IN USE document the awareness date

event date

The date on which the reported occurrence took place.

IN USE confirm the event date

receipt date

The date the organization received the communication.

IN USE record the receipt date

Unique Device Identifier

A device-identification code with defined identification components.

IN USE capture the Unique Device Identifier

serial number

An identifier distinguishing an individual unit.

IN USE verify the serial number

lot number

An identifier linking items to a production batch.

IN USE record the lot number

Precision check

The receipt time is not the event time. Unknown patient outcome is not the same as no injury. Preserve the reporter's account and route the available information through the applicable process while actively seeking missing facts.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

patient outcome

The reported effect on the patient's condition or health.

IN USE clarify the patient outcome

causal relationship

A supported connection between a device and an observed event.

IN USE assess the causal relationship

event narrative

A factual account of the reported occurrence and its context.

IN USE preserve the event narrative

reasonably known information

Information available or obtainable as defined by the applicable reporting requirement.

IN USE provide reasonably known information

follow-up attempt

A documented effort to obtain missing or clarifying information.

IN USE record a follow-up attempt

supplemental report

A later report providing required additional information.

IN USE submit a supplemental report

postmarket surveillance

Systematic collection and review of information after market introduction.

IN USE conduct postmarket surveillance

safety signal

Information suggesting a potential safety issue that needs assessment.

IN USE investigate a safety signal

trend analysis

Review of patterns in data over time.

IN USE perform trend analysis

exposure denominator

The relevant use or exposure quantity against which events are compared.

IN USE identify the exposure denominator

duplicate report

Another record potentially describing an already reported event.

IN USE assess duplicate reports

complaint closure

Documented completion of the required complaint-review process.

IN USE authorize complaint closure

06

Precision check

Eight complaints versus four is a doubled count, not automatically a doubled rate per use or proof of causation. Reporting patterns, duplicates, exposure, and case differences matter. In this chapter, MDR means US Medical Device Reporting, not the EU Medical Device Regulation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CAPTURE THE ACCOUNT

"The caller reported that the display stopped unexpectedly."

MARK A MISSING IDENTIFIER

"We have not yet confirmed the device identifier."

AVOID CAUSAL CERTAINTY

"This report does not by itself establish the cause."

CONTINUE FOLLOW-UP

"Record the questions asked and the attempts to obtain missing information."

SEPARATE DATES

"The call was received today; the event date is still unknown."

PRESERVE OUTCOME UNCERTAINTY

"Patient outcome has not been established."

ROUTE AVAILABLE FACTS

"Send the available information for prompt internal assessment."

DISTINGUISH THE REVIEW

"Reportability needs assessment under the applicable requirements."

06

Reported

Attributes information without treating every detail as independently verified.

Unknown

A distinct status, not a synonym for no or none.

Received

Describes the communication date, not necessarily when the event occurred.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A BLANKET RULE

"Missing fields do not justify withholding the initial internal handoff."

STATE THE COUNT

"The count increased from four to eight."

AVOID DISMISSAL

"An incomplete account still needs appropriate review."

NAME THE UPDATE ROUTE

"New required information must follow the applicable reporting process."

USE THE RIGHT DENOMINATOR

"We need the relevant exposure data before describing a rate."

CHECK DUPLICATES

"Confirm whether separate records describe the same event."

PRESERVE THE ORIGINAL

"Keep the initial narrative alongside later clarifications."

CLOSE WITH STATUS

"The case is routed, follow-up is open, and no cause is confirmed."

06

Reportable

Requires the relevant criteria; not every complaint has the same reporting obligation.

Doubled

State whether a count, rate, or other measure doubled.

Caused

A causal conclusion needs more support than temporal association alone.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which intake sentence preserves the facts?

- A Case closed because the serial number is missing.
- B Display interruption reported; event date, identifier, and patient outcome unknown; call received today at 14:10.
- C No injury and no malfunction; event occurred today at 14:10.
- D Confirmed device-caused injury at an unknown hospital.

2. What is the appropriate internal handoff wording?

- A Reject the report because the caller lacks an identifier.
- B Declare it nonreportable without the required assessment.
- C Route the available account promptly for assessment and continue documented follow-up.
- D Hold the case indefinitely until every field is complete.

3. What does the dashboard support?

- A The injury rate doubled exactly.
- B Device causation doubled exactly.
- C Eight complaints prove eight unique serious injuries.
- D The count rose from four to eight; the rate per use is not established.

4. The caller later reports no injury. Which update preserves the information history and review responsibilities?

- A Replace the original unknown field as though no injury was established at first receipt.
- B Close reporting assessment automatically because no injury is now reported.
- C Remove the original narrative because a later account supersedes every earlier detail.
- D Add the attributed clarification and its receipt time; continue the applicable reporting assessment.

Answers and explanations: page 95.

Incomplete information still needs a handoff

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

supplemental report / event narrative / causal relationship / Unique Device Identifier / duplicate report / follow-up attempt / receipt date / reportability / patient outcome / exposure denominator

- 01 **Dev:** The caller said the monitor stopped displaying, but the device identifier and event date are missing. I thought we should wait before sending an incomplete record onward.
- 02 **Nora:** We should route the available ¹ _____ for prompt internal assessment and continue follow-up. An incomplete account is not a reason to withhold it from the responsible team.
- 03 **Dev:** I have routed the account now. The call arrived today at fourteen ten; the event date is still unknown.
- 04 **Nora:** I have received it for assessment. Record the ² _____ and time separately; do not copy them into the unknown event-date field.
- 05 **Dev:** The caller did not tell us whether anyone was injured. The draft summary says no injury, which is more definite than the information actually supports.
- 06 **Nora:** Change ³ _____ to unknown. We should ask for clarification and record the response without treating silence in the first call as a confirmed absence of harm.
- 07 **Dev:** We also need to identify the unit accurately. A model name alone might not let the investigation team distinguish this device from other units at the site.
- 08 **Nora:** Seek the ⁴ _____ and other relevant identification details through the approved process. Record what is available rather than inventing a serial number to complete the form.
- 09 **Dev:** Is this automatically reportable because the display stopped? Service needs to avoid delay without deciding beyond its role.
- 10 **Nora:** The responsible team must assess ⁵ _____ under the applicable requirements. Preserve the account and route it promptly; do not replace the assessment with an automatic yes or no.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Dev:** I will document the missing questions and the calls we make to obtain answers. The case should show what we tried, not simply remain blank.
- 12 **Nora:** Each ⁶ _____ helps make the information history clear. New facts should be linked to their source, including when they became available and any earlier uncertainty they resolve.
- 13 **Dev:** The summary says device-caused. Where did that conclusion come from? The caller described the display stopping; we do not yet have the cause.
- 14 **Nora:** Then the ⁷ _____ remains unconfirmed. Report the observation accurately without either asserting device causation or dismissing the device as unrelated before the evidence supports that conclusion.
- 15 **Dev:** The quarterly dashboard adds another concern: eight complaints this quarter and four last quarter. The presentation says the rate doubled, but there is no use-volume information.
- 16 **Nora:** We lack the ⁸ _____. The count doubled; the rate per use is not established. We also need to examine reporting patterns and whether the records are comparable.
- 17 **Dev:** Some records might refer to the same occurrence. We should check that before treating every entry as a separate event or comparing the clinical outcomes.
- 18 **Nora:** Yes, assess each possible ⁹ _____ while preserving the source information. Deduplication needs a basis; a similar description alone should not make us erase a separate event.
- 19 **Dev:** The account is routed and you have confirmed receipt. I will correct the unknown fields and retain eight versus four complaints without inventing a rate or injury outcome.
- 20 **Nora:** Good. Any required later information must follow the applicable ¹⁰ _____ process. Keep investigation, reporting assessment, and complaint closure distinct so the record never suggests an unfinished task has already been completed.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. event narrative | 2. receipt date | 3. patient outcome | 4. Unique Device Identifier | 5. reportability | 6. follow-up attempt | 7. causal relationship | 8. exposure denominator | 9. duplicate report | 10. supplemental report

The report date is known

F Say it

A caller reports a device issue today. The event date and outcome are unknown. Six complaints were recorded this month, but the number of uses is unavailable.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

count / received / denominator / unknown

Specialist: "Today is the date the report was ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The patient outcome is still ² _____."

Specialist: "Six is the complaint ³ _____."

Colleague: "A use-based rate needs the exposure ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. received | 2. unknown | 3. count | 4. denominator

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the intake exchange. Route the account and confirm receipt before discussing missing details; preserve 14:10 as call receipt.

2. Swap roles. Say outcome unknown rather than no injury, and doubled count rather than doubled use-based rate.

3. Read the corrected six-complaint transfer. Keep event date unknown and the exposure denominator unavailable.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three hundred pieces on hold

A Read the situation

Separate affected-lot scope, observed failures, containment, cause, and authorized disposition in a supplier discussion.

Quality engineer Tomas and supply planner Grace review two incoming component lots containing 120 and 180 pieces. One sampled piece from each lot failed a specified dimensional check. Both lots are on hold under the fictional site procedure. The cause is not established, and no release or rework disposition is authorized. Production needs parts tomorrow. Grace proposes describing all 300 pieces as defective, then releasing the second lot because its supplier certificate says conforming.

PEOPLE / Tomas: Quality engineer | Grace: Supply planner

07

BE FIRM ABOUT STATUS AND EXACT ABOUT SCOPE

Quality communication should not soften a hold into an informal preference, but it should not overstate the evidence either. Name the held population, the inspected failures, and the authorized next step separately. Production urgency can be acknowledged without becoming an unsupported release rationale.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many pieces are in the two held lots?

A 2

B 120

C 180

D 300

2. How many sampled pieces are explicitly reported as failing?

A Every piece in the second lot

B None because a certificate exists

C Two, one from each lot

D All 300

3. What is the current disposition?

A The second lot is released automatically.

B Both lots must be reworked using any available method.

C All pieces are confirmed scrap.

D Both lots remain on hold; no release or rework is authorized.

[Answers and explanations: page 97.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

incoming inspection

Examination of received material against specified requirements.

IN USE perform incoming inspection

nonconformance

Failure to fulfill a specified requirement.

IN USE document a nonconformance

nonconforming material

Material identified as not meeting a specified requirement.

IN USE control nonconforming material

containment

Immediate action to limit the scope or spread of a problem.

IN USE implement containment

quarantine

Controlled segregation or status preventing unintended use.

IN USE place material in quarantine

disposition

An authorized decision on how identified material will be handled.

IN USE approve material disposition

rework

Action intended to bring nonconforming product into conformity.

IN USE authorize a rework instruction

scrap

Material designated not to be used for its intended production purpose.

IN USE document a scrap decision

concession

An authorized permission to use or release specified nonconforming product under defined conditions.

IN USE evaluate a concession request

certificate of conformity

A supplier statement that supplied material meets specified requirements.

IN USE review the certificate of conformity

supplier corrective action request

A formal request for a supplier to address a quality problem.

IN USE issue a supplier corrective action request

corrective action

Action addressing the cause of a nonconformity to prevent recurrence.

IN USE verify corrective action

Precision check

The held population is 300 pieces. The supplied observation is two failed sampled pieces, one from each lot. Do not call all 300 individually confirmed defective, or treat uninspected pieces as conforming. The hold and the observed failures describe different scopes.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

correction

Action addressing a detected nonconformity itself.

IN USE distinguish correction from corrective action

CAPA

Corrective and preventive action within a quality-system process.

IN USE assess the need for CAPA

lot genealogy

Records linking material lots through production and distribution.

IN USE trace lot genealogy

acceptance sampling

Evaluation of a lot using a defined sample and decision plan.

IN USE apply an acceptance-sampling plan

dimensional tolerance

The permitted variation in a specified measurement.

IN USE check dimensional tolerance

measurement uncertainty

The quantified uncertainty associated with a measurement result.

IN USE evaluate measurement uncertainty

calibration status

Whether a measuring instrument's calibration requirements are satisfied.

IN USE verify calibration status

supplier qualification

Evaluation and approval of a supplier for a defined purpose.

IN USE maintain supplier qualification

change notification

Communication of a proposed or implemented change affecting supply.

IN USE require a change notification

release status

The current authorization state for using or distributing material.

IN USE verify release status

Quality Management System Regulation

The current US device quality-system regulation, commonly called QMSR.

IN USE follow the Quality Management System Regulation

ISO 13485

An international standard for medical-device quality management systems.

IN USE apply ISO 13485 requirements

Precision check

A supplier certificate does not cancel contrary inspection evidence or authorize release. Containment, correction, corrective action, and disposition are different steps. Since February 2026, the US framework is QMSR, incorporating ISO 13485:2016, rather than the former QSR framework.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE HELD POPULATION

"Both lots are on hold, totaling 300 pieces."

AVOID OVERSTATING SCOPE

"We have not inspected and confirmed every piece as defective."

NAME THE REQUIREMENT

"Reference the specified dimension and applicable tolerance."

ACKNOWLEDGE URGENCY

"I understand tomorrow's need; the material status still has to be respected."

STATE THE OBSERVED FAILURES

"One sampled piece from each lot failed the dimensional check."

AVOID ASSUMING CONFORMITY

"The uninspected pieces are not thereby proven conforming."

PRESERVE THE HOLD

"No release or rework disposition is authorized."

ASSESS CONTRARY EVIDENCE

"The certificate does not erase the failed inspection result."

Affected

Define whether this means held, inspected, failed, or potentially involved.

Defective

Avoid applying the label to an unexamined population without support.

Held

Describes a controlled status, not a final scrap decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE CONTAINMENT

"The hold limits unintended use while the issue is assessed."

REQUEST A RESPONSE

"Ask for evidence addressing the specified nonconformance."

VERIFY THE INSTRUMENT

"Include calibration status and relevant measurement information in the review."

DEFINE AUTHORIZATION

"Only the designated process can approve the material disposition."

KEEP CAUSE OPEN

"The supplier cause has not been established."

CLARIFY CORRECTIVE ACTION

"Fixing a piece and preventing recurrence are different objectives."

TRACE THE SCOPE

"Use lot records to assess what other material may be affected."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Give production the confirmed status and the next review time, not an assumed release."

Certificate

A supplier statement that remains subject to relevant acceptance evidence.

Rework

Needs the required authorization and controlled instructions.

Cause

An investigation conclusion, not something established by urgency or suspicion.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which quantity statement is accurate?

- A** Only two pieces are held.
- B** The 180-piece lot has no failed result.
- C** Three hundred pieces are held; two sampled pieces are explicitly reported as failing.
- D** All 300 pieces were individually tested and failed.

07

2. Production proposes using the 180-piece lot because its certificate is conforming. Which response preserves the current evidence and authority?

- A** The production deadline supplies temporary release authority pending the investigation.
- B** The failed sample and hold remain; the certificate does not replace an authorized disposition.
- C** The certificate releases the lot, while only its failed sample remains on hold.
- D** The lot is usable because the other 179 pieces have not been reported as failed.

3. Which statement distinguishes correction from corrective action?

- A** Correction always proves the cause is known.
- B** Corrective action is complete when material is placed on hold.
- C** Correction addresses the detected problem; corrective action addresses its cause to prevent recurrence.
- D** Both terms mean signing a supplier certificate.

4. Which supplier update is best supported?

- A** The cause remains open; provide relevant evidence while both lots retain their current hold status.
- B** Your process definitely caused every piece to fail.
- C** The second lot is released because its certificate is favorable.
- D** Rework is authorized despite the absence of a disposition.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

Three hundred pieces on hold

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

disposition / certificate of conformity / nonconformance / Incoming inspection / corrective action / calibration status / lot genealogy / containment / correction / release status

07

- 01 **Grace:** Production needs the parts tomorrow. The lots contain 120 and 180 pieces. I was about to report all 300 as defective, but that overstates our inspection.
- 02 **Tomas:** ¹ _____ found two failed sampled pieces, one per lot. Both lots are held; those are different quantities and different statements.
- 03 **Grace:** So the report needs three hundred held, two observed failures. We cannot assign an individual result to pieces that were not inspected.
- 04 **Tomas:** Correct. Link each ² _____ to the dimensional requirement and lot. Uninspected does not mean conforming, either; keep the hold status visible.
- 05 **Grace:** The 180-piece lot has a supplier certificate saying conforming. Can that support using it while we investigate the failed sample?
- 06 **Tomas:** The ³ _____ does not override contrary inspection evidence. That lot remains held unless the authorized process establishes a different disposition.
- 07 **Grace:** I will tell production both lots remain unavailable. We have not established whether the two sampled failures have the same cause.
- 08 **Tomas:** Exactly. ⁴ _____ can be in place while cause remains open. Controlling the material does not require us to pretend the investigation is complete.
- 09 **Grace:** Could I ask quality about rework tonight? I need to offer production a next step without accidentally authorizing work myself.
- 10 **Tomas:** Request a ⁵ _____ review. Do not tell anyone to rework or use material before the required decision, instructions, and evaluation are in place.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Grace:** Then tonight is a request for review, not an expected release. I should give production the actual status and the next update we can commit to.
- 12 **Tomas:** Keep ⁶ _____ separate from the deadline. Schedule pressure can make the review urgent; it cannot provide evidence or approval.
- 13 **Grace:** The supplier offers to replace the two failed samples. That might address those particular pieces, but does not explain the dimensional problem.
- 14 **Tomas:** Replacement could be a ⁷ _____ through the approved process. It would not by itself establish the cause or prevent the same issue recurring.
- 15 **Grace:** I will request their manufacturing and inspection records. We should also examine our measurement setup rather than begin by assigning fault to the supplier.
- 16 **Tomas:** Include our instrument's ⁸ _____ and the relevant results. A certificate or a suspicion is not a substitute for the evidence from either side.
- 17 **Grace:** Once a cause is supported, I will ask what action addresses it and how effectiveness will be checked. A promise about future lots is not enough.
- 18 **Tomas:** That is the purpose of ⁹ _____. Distinguish the action against recurrence from replacing a piece or maintaining the current hold.
- 19 **Grace:** For now: three hundred held, two sampled failures, cause open, no release or rework authorized. I will send that exact status to production.
- 20 **Tomas:** Use ¹⁰ _____ to check whether other material may be involved. Keep any wider scope qualified until the records support it.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. Incoming inspection | 2. nonconformance | 3. certificate of conformity | 4. containment | 5. disposition | 6. release status | 7. correction | 8. calibration status | 9. corrective action | 10. lot genealogy

Held does not mean every piece failed

F Say it

A lot contains 90 pieces. Two sampled pieces failed a check. The whole lot is held, and no rework or release is authorized.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

disposition / status / two / ninety

Planner: "The held quantity is ¹ _____."

Engineer: "The stated number of failed sampled pieces is ² _____."

Planner: "The handling decision still needs authorized ³ _____."

Engineer: "A production deadline does not change the release
⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. ninety | 2. two | 3. disposition | 4. status

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the supplier exchange. State 120 plus 180 equals 300 held, with two observed sampled failures.

2. Swap roles. Keep both lots held, cause open, and release or rework unapproved despite the certificate and deadline.

3. Read the corrected ninety-piece transfer. Distinguish ninety held from two sampled failures and a disposition still required.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A useful question outside this session

A Read the situation

Acknowledge an out-of-scope product-use request, keep the demonstration within authorized materials, and arrange a precise follow-up.

Clinical trainer Sora is delivering a fictional device session using version 4 of internally approved materials for adult outpatient use. Clinician Alex asks for a pediatric home-use demonstration that the session materials do not cover. A version 3 slide remains in Sora's folder, but its current status has not been checked. No expanded-use authorization or reviewed response is supplied. Sora must acknowledge the question, avoid improvising the requested demonstration, and route it without implying that the clinician's question is improper.

PEOPLE / Sora: Clinical trainer | Alex: Clinician attending the session

08

A BOUNDARY CAN INCLUDE A NEXT STEP

A useful response names what you can cover now and what needs another route. Do not shame the questioner or pretend the question was answered by a disclaimer. Keep product training, a clinician's independent judgment, and the organization's approved response process distinct.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What do the current session materials cover?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Every possible setting and population | B A newly authorized expanded indication |
| C Adult outpatient use, version 4 | D Pediatric home use under every condition |

2. What is missing for the requested demonstration?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A question from a clinician | B A previous version in the folder |
| C Reviewed materials covering the requested pediatric home-use context | D A willing audience |

3. What should Sora avoid implying?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A That the requested use is not covered by these materials | B That the question is improper merely because it is outside the session scope |
| C That version 4 is the session's current material | D That a follow-up route is needed |

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

labeling

Device-related written, printed, or graphic information accompanying or relating to the product.

IN USE review current labeling

instructions for use

The device's documented directions and relevant use information.

IN USE consult the instructions for use

indication

A specified condition or purpose for which use is described.

IN USE confirm the stated indication

contraindication

A circumstance in which the device should not be used.

IN USE identify a contraindication

warning

Information highlighting a significant hazard or safety concern.

IN USE communicate the relevant warning

precaution

Information about care needed to avoid problems during appropriate use.

IN USE explain a precaution

training scope

The users, tasks, settings, and content covered by a session.

IN USE define the training scope

approved material

Content authorized through the relevant internal review process.

IN USE use current approved materials

version control

Management of revisions so the appropriate version is used.

IN USE maintain version control

obsolete copy

A superseded document that is no longer the current controlled version.

IN USE remove an obsolete copy

demonstration unit

A device or model designated for showing functions under specified conditions.

IN USE identify the demonstration unit

simulation

A representation of a task or setting used for training or evaluation.

IN USE conduct a training simulation

Precision check

Internally approved training material is not the same thing as a new regulatory authorization. A version number in a folder does not establish that the document is current. Confirm status through the controlled source rather than using an unchecked older slide.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

in-service training

Instruction delivered to professionals in their work context.

IN USE schedule in-service training

competency assessment

Evaluation against defined knowledge or performance criteria.

IN USE distinguish attendance from competency assessment

attendance record

A record that a person participated in a session.

IN USE maintain an attendance record

scope boundary

The limit of what a session or role is authorized to cover.

IN USE state the scope boundary

off-label use

Use outside the product's authorized labeling, where that concept applies.

IN USE route an off-label-use question

unsolicited question

A question initiated by the recipient rather than prompted by the presenter.

IN USE document an unsolicited question

medical information request

A request routed for an appropriate reviewed scientific or product response.

IN USE route a medical information request

promotional claim

A statement used to encourage product selection or use.

IN USE review a promotional claim

disclaimer

A statement explaining a limitation or qualification.

IN USE avoid relying on a disclaimer alone

escalation route

The designated path for a question beyond the current role or scope.

IN USE follow the escalation route

follow-up commitment

A specified promise about the next communication or action.

IN USE make a realistic follow-up commitment

teach-back

Asking a learner to restate or demonstrate key information to check understanding.

IN USE use teach-back appropriately

08

Precision check

Outside this session is narrower than clinically forbidden. The trainer should not turn a session boundary into unsupported medical or legal advice. A disclaimer does not make an otherwise unsupported demonstration appropriate; route the specific question through the applicable process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE QUESTION

"That is a specific and useful question about a different population and setting."

NAME THE BOUNDARY

"These materials do not cover pediatric home use."

AVOID JUDGING THE QUESTION

"The limitation is the scope of my materials, not your ability to ask."

KEEP THE REQUEST PRECISE

"I will preserve the population and setting you asked about."

STATE THE SESSION SCOPE

"Today we are covering adult outpatient use with version 4 materials."

DECLINE THE DEMONSTRATION

"I cannot improvise that demonstration within this session."

OFFER THE NEXT ROUTE

"I can document the question for the appropriate reviewed response."

CHECK THE SOURCE

"I need to confirm the current controlled version before using that slide."

08

Approved

Identify whether the approval concerns materials, product marketing, or another decision.

Current

Means the valid controlled version, not merely the latest file someone remembers.

Outside scope

States a boundary without making a universal clinical prohibition.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE APPROVAL TYPES

"Internal material approval does not create an expanded product authorization."

RESPECT CLINICAL ROLES

"I am not making a patient-specific treatment recommendation."

BOUND THE PROMISE

"I can confirm that the request was routed; I cannot promise a particular answer."

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

"Please restate which use context today's session covers."

AVOID A DISCLAIMER SHORTCUT

"Adding a disclaimer would not resolve the missing reviewed content."

CLARIFY RECORDS

"Session attendance is not the same as a completed competency assessment."

KEEP THE DEMONSTRATION ALIGNED

"We will continue with the functions covered by the current session materials."

CLOSE RESPECTFULLY

"I will follow up through the designated route while we keep this session within scope."

08

Cannot demonstrate

A role-and-material limit, not a claim that the question is illegitimate.

Will route

Promises an action, not the outcome of the reviewed response.

Attended

Confirms participation; it does not automatically establish competence.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which reply is best supported?

- A** The question is improper and must not be recorded.
- B** Pediatric home use is authorized because a clinician asked about it.
- C** I can demonstrate anything after adding a disclaimer.
- D** These materials cover adult outpatient use; I can route your pediatric home-use question for a reviewed response.

2. How should Sora handle the version 3 slide?

- A** Assume it remains current because it is in the folder.
- B** Treat its existence as expanded-use authorization.
- C** Present it and correct any discrepancy after the session.
- D** Check its status against the controlled source before using it.

3. The attendance sheet is complete after the session. What does that establish?

- A** Recorded participation in this session, not performance against competency criteria
- B** Competence for every task mentioned by a participant during questions
- C** Authorization for pediatric home use because the topic was discussed
- D** Completion of a skills assessment for all functions on the demonstration unit

4. Which follow-up commitment is appropriate?

- A** I will supply an improvised protocol tonight.
- B** The reviewed response will certainly endorse the request.
- C** I will route the exact question and confirm the next communication through the designated process.
- D** I guarantee approval of the requested use.

Answers and explanations: page 99.

A useful question outside this session

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

attendance record / approved material / unsolicited question / training scope / disclaimer / competency assessment / escalation route / version control / medical information request / follow-up commitment

08

- 01 **Alex:** Could you demonstrate pediatric home use? Our team has a question about that setting, although today's examples have been outpatient adults.
- 02 **Sora:** I can document the question, but today's ¹ _____ is adult outpatient use. The version four materials do not cover the pediatric home-use demonstration you are requesting.
- 03 **Alex:** I understand the session limit. I am not asking you to make a decision for an individual patient; I want to know where the product question can be addressed.
- 04 **Sora:** Thank you. I can use the designated ² _____ for an appropriate reviewed response. I should preserve your specific population and setting rather than turn the request into a generic product question.
- 05 **Alex:** Would an older slide help? A previous presentation mentioned another setting, though I am unsure whether it covered this device version.
- 06 **Sora:** I have an older file, but its ³ _____ status has not been checked. A slide in my folder is not enough to establish that it is current or relevant.
- 07 **Alex:** That makes sense. Please do not use an uncertain slide simply to answer immediately. A reviewed response would be more useful than a demonstration built from partial information.
- 08 **Sora:** I will use only the current ⁴ _____ for this session. Internal approval of those materials also should not be confused with an expanded regulatory authorization for the product.
- 09 **Alex:** Could you still show the requested setup with a disclaimer that it is outside today's scope? I want to understand whether that would resolve your concern.
- 10 **Sora:** A ⁵ _____ would not supply the missing reviewed content. I cannot improvise the demonstration and then rely on a sentence saying it is outside the materials.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Alex:** Understood. Please do not imply that my question was inappropriate. We need to be able to ask about uses outside a session's scope.
- 12 **Sora:** Absolutely. An ⁶ _____ can be documented respectfully. The boundary concerns what I can demonstrate here, not your ability to raise a specific scientific or product question.
- 13 **Alex:** Please keep pediatric home use in the request. A general adult outpatient answer would not address the population and setting our team is asking about.
- 14 **Sora:** I will retain that distinction in the ⁷ _____ and follow the appropriate process. We do not need to add patient-specific details that are unnecessary for this product-level question.
- 15 **Alex:** Thank you. While we stay with today's materials, could you clarify what the attendance certificate represents? Our team should not confuse participation with a broader qualification.
- 16 **Sora:** The ⁸ _____ confirms participation. It does not by itself establish that someone has met every competency criterion or is authorized for every possible clinical use.
- 17 **Alex:** Then competence requires the relevant assessment; a name on the session list does not demonstrate it.
- 18 **Sora:** Correct. A ⁹ _____ has defined criteria. We should describe exactly what was assessed and avoid extending that result to populations or tasks outside the assessment.
- 19 **Alex:** Please route that question and tell me how we will hear back. We can continue with today's adult outpatient material while the separate response is pending.
- 20 **Sora:** I will make that ¹⁰ _____ through the designated process. I can confirm the action and next contact, but I cannot promise that the reviewed response will endorse the requested use.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. training scope | 2. escalation route | 3. version control | 4. approved material | 5. disclaimer | 6. unsolicited question | 7. medical information request | 8. attendance record | 9. competency assessment | 10. follow-up commitment

Stay specific when routing a question

F Say it

A session covers adult clinic use. A participant asks about pediatric home use. No reviewed material for that request is available, and the trainer will route it.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

authorized / response / home / clinic

08

Trainer: "Today's approved materials cover adult ¹ _____ use."

Participant: "My question concerns pediatric use at ² _____."

Trainer: "I will route the exact request for a reviewed ³ _____."

Participant: "That does not mean the requested use is already
⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. clinic | 2. home | 3. response | 4. authorized

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the training exchange. Preserve version 4 adult outpatient scope and the specific pediatric home-use question.
2. Swap roles. Route the request without improvising a demonstration or treating the question as improper.
3. Read the corrected referral transfer. Routing for a reviewed response does not authorize the requested use.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A small software patch still needs an impact assessment

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain the evidence and decisions required before a device-software update.

A device team has corrected a software defect in a test build. The fix passes its targeted test, but wider regression work and regulatory assessment are incomplete. The product manager wants to send the update to customers. No release is authorized.

PEOPLE / Ari: Software quality engineer | Sofia: Device product manager

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

deployment plan / change-impact assessment / submission assessment / configuration baseline / regression testing / recovery procedure

- 01 **Sofia:** The targeted test passes. Can we send the patch to customers this afternoon and finish the remaining paperwork afterward?
- 02 **Ari:** Not yet. The ¹ _____ is incomplete. A passing defect test covers one question, not the whole release.
- 03 **Sofia:** It is only a few lines of code. I thought that made it a minor maintenance change.
- 04 **Ari:** Code size does not establish clinical or functional impact. We need to trace the changed behavior and anything that depends on it.
- 05 **Sofia:** Which evidence should I expect besides repeating the test that originally exposed the defect?
- 06 **Ari:** The justified ² _____ and other required checks, tied to the affected functions and risk review.
- 07 **Sofia:** The dashboard still shows green results from the previous version. Those should not appear to cover the new build automatically.
- 08 **Ari:** Correct. Confirm the ³ _____ for every relevant report so the release package refers to what was actually tested.
- 09 **Sofia:** Does any software change require a new submission, or can we assume a bug fix never does?
- 10 **Ari:** Neither blanket statement is appropriate. Regulatory affairs must document the ⁴ _____ for this device and change.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Sofia:** We should also consider what customers will need to do and how the update reaches the installed devices.
- 12 **Ari:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ needs the affected configurations, customer instructions, and confirmation steps reviewed.
- 13 **Sofia:** Support proposed a simple message saying the update has no effect on existing workflows. We have not evaluated that claim yet.
- 14 **Ari:** Then do not include it as fact. Explain the verified change and any reviewed user implications without adding reassurance the evidence does not support.
- 15 **Sofia:** What happens if installation does not complete? Customers will need an approved route for that situation.
- 16 **Ari:** The relevant ⁶ _____ and support arrangements must be established through the controlled process.
- 17 **Sofia:** I will change today's milestone from customer release to completion of the review package. The targeted test result can stay visible.
- 18 **Ari:** That is accurate. Keep the open regression and regulatory items beside it, with owners and the evidence needed to close them.
- 19 **Sofia:** Once those are complete, I will ask for the authorized release decision rather than infer approval from a green dashboard.
- 20 **Ari:** And the customer communication must identify the approved version. A corrected defect, a completed review, and an installed update are different milestones.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. change-impact assessment | 2. regression testing | 3. configuration baseline | 4. submission assessment | 5. deployment plan | 6. recovery procedure

Old test results are attached to a new build

F Say it in a new situation

A release package links test results from build 4.1 to a modified build 4.2 without an impact assessment.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

change / version / package / recorded

09

Engineer: These results identify build 4.1, not the modified ¹ _____.

Manager: Assess which conclusions remain applicable after the ² _____.

Engineer: Keep the open work visible in the review ³ _____.

Manager: Do not communicate release until the authorized decision is ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. version | 2. change | 3. package | 4. recorded

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

A field notice reaches the hospital, but not every affected unit

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Track a device field action using identifiers and confirmed completion rather than email counts.

An approved fictional field notice identifies a particular model and serial-number range. A distributor has emailed ten hospitals, but no device-level responses have been received. The field-action coordinator and service lead must establish implementation status under the authorized plan. They are not determining the notice's clinical instructions or regulatory classification.

PEOPLE / Lena: Field-action coordinator | Omar: Service lead

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

closure / Acknowledgment / distribution records / device-level reconciliation / affected population / effectiveness checks

- 01 **Omar:** The distributor emailed all ten hospitals. Can the dashboard show the field action as complete?
- 02 **Lena:** It can show notifications sent. We still need the ¹ _____ reconciled to the model and serial-number range in the approved notice.
- 03 **Omar:** Some hospitals have several units, and devices may have moved between departments since purchase.
- 04 **Lena:** Then use the ² _____ to begin the trace, followed by the required customer confirmation.
- 05 **Omar:** The hospital contact may acknowledge the email without checking every unit. We need that distinction in the response form.
- 06 **Lena:** Exactly. ³ _____ is a communication milestone, not proof that the instructions were carried out.
- 07 **Omar:** One customer asks whether an older unit of the same model is included. Its serial number is outside the notice's range.
- 08 **Lena:** Check the exact identifier against the approved scope. Do not expand or narrow the notice casually; route any ambiguity to the responsible team.
- 09 **Omar:** Another contact asks what to do with a device currently in clinical use. I should not improvise a recommendation during the service call.
- 10 **Lena:** Use the approved instructions and the designated clinical or technical escalation route. Our coordination must not alter the authorized message.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Omar:** For each affected unit, we should capture the action status and the supporting confirmation required by the plan.
- 12 **Lena:** Yes. That is ⁴ _____. Keep unknown locations and unanswered requests visible as open items.
- 13 **Omar:** Can a nonresponse be treated as no affected stock? The distributor says silence usually means there is nothing to report.
- 14 **Lena:** No. Silence is not a verified inventory result. Follow the plan's contact and escalation steps and record the attempts accurately.
- 15 **Omar:** How do we judge whether the notification process itself has worked?
- 16 **Lena:** The plan includes ⁵ _____. Their results must be evaluated, not replaced by the number of emails in the sent folder.
- 17 **Omar:** I will keep receipt, device identification, and action completion as separate fields in the worklist.
- 18 **Lena:** Good. Any formal ⁶ _____ must follow the responsible team's review and applicable requirements.
- 19 **Omar:** Today's update will say ten hospitals contacted, responses pending, and no device-level completion yet confirmed.
- 20 **Lena:** That gives us a reliable starting point for follow-up without suggesting the safety communication has reached every device or been fully implemented.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. affected population | 2. distribution records | 3. Acknowledgment | 4. device-level reconciliation | 5. effectiveness checks | 6. closure

One hospital reply is counted as six completed devices

F Say it in a new situation

A hospital with six potentially affected devices acknowledges a notice. Its reply does not identify the devices or confirm the required action.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

completion / status / plan / verified

10

Service lead: The reply confirms receipt, not device-level ¹ _____.

Coordinator: Obtain the required device identifiers and action ² _____.

Service lead: Keep the six units pending until the evidence is ³ _____.

Coordinator: Route unresolved cases through the approved follow-up
⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. completion | 2. status | 3. verified | 4. plan

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

A new carton does not automatically preserve a sterile package

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain packaging-system evidence and distinguish barrier integrity from a cosmetic change.

A device manufacturer proposes a smaller shipping carton for a terminally sterilized product. The inner sterile package is unchanged, but the fit and protective inserts will change. Existing distribution and shelf-life evidence relates to the old packaging configuration. No change is approved.

PEOPLE / Keira: Packaging engineer | Noah: Operations manager

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

package-integrity / aseptic presentation / packaging system / shelf-life / configuration / sterile barrier

11

- 01 **Noah:** The smaller carton reduces shipping volume, and the inner pouch is unchanged. Can we classify this as a purely cosmetic change?
- 02 **Keira:** Not from that fact alone. The ¹ _____ includes how the barrier is protected during handling, transport, and storage.
- 03 **Noah:** The new insert holds the device more tightly. That could change where loads are applied to the pouch.
- 04 **Keira:** Exactly. We need an impact assessment for the ² _____ and the product, not just a comparison of carton dimensions.
- 05 **Noah:** We already have a transport report. Why would its conclusions need review if the same carrier handles the shipment?
- 06 **Keira:** The tested ³ _____ was different. The carrier's identity does not show that the new arrangement behaves the same way.
- 07 **Noah:** Would a photograph after a trial shipment be enough to show that the pouch still looks intact?
- 08 **Keira:** Visual observations may contribute, but the plan needs justified ⁴ _____ evidence and the other applicable performance checks.
- 09 **Noah:** The commercial team also wants to keep the same shelf-life claim. The carton change should not become an automatic extension.
- 10 **Keira:** Correct. Review the ⁵ _____ support and determine what remains applicable. Keep the claim tied to the assessed configuration and conditions.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Noah:** Could a passing seal-strength result cover everything? It would be easier to explain one number than several reports.
- 12 **Keira:** No single number automatically covers the whole system. Seal strength, integrity, product protection, and opening performance answer related but different questions.
- 13 **Noah:** Opening matters too. A tighter insert could make removal harder even if transport protection improves.
- 14 **Keira:** Yes, consider ⁶ _____ and the intended handling sequence through the appropriate evaluation.
- 15 **Noah:** I will tell procurement this is a proposal under review. They should not replace the approved carton merely because the new one is available.
- 16 **Keira:** Good. We also need the exact component specifications and suppliers tied to the change record so the evaluation matches what would be purchased.
- 17 **Noah:** Can you give the review team a list of existing evidence, the gaps, and the proposed basis for any additional work?
- 18 **Keira:** Yes. We will justify the plan rather than automatically discard every earlier result or assume it all transfers unchanged.
- 19 **Noah:** Then the savings case will remain conditional on the quality, performance, and regulatory review required for the change.
- 20 **Keira:** That is the right status. Smaller shipping volume is a business benefit, not evidence that the revised packaging protects sterility and function.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. packaging system | 2. sterile barrier | 3. configuration | 4. package-integrity | 5. shelf-life | 6. aseptic presentation

A packaging test covers an earlier insert

F Say it in a new situation

A distribution-test report identifies insert A. The proposed package uses insert B, and no impact assessment has been completed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reviewed / conclusion / decision / configuration

Engineer: The report covers the earlier packaging ¹ _____.

Manager: Assess the effect of the new insert before reusing the
² _____.

Engineer: Keep the change pending while the required evidence is
³ _____.

Manager: Do not substitute components before the authorized change
⁴ _____.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. configuration | 2. conclusion | 3. reviewed | 4. decision

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

User Needs and Design Inputs

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Who is the agreed initial audience?

B. Trained clinic staff

The brief names trained clinic staff and treats home caregivers as an unassessed expansion.

2. What is the status of the two-minute target?

A. Proposed, not reviewed or approved

The scenario explicitly describes an unreviewed proposal rather than an established criterion.

3. What additional evidence question follows from adding home caregivers to the brief?

D. Whether the new users, training, tasks, and home conditions support the proposed use

A new user group and setting can change how the device is used. Existing clinic scope and a proposed time target do not establish performance for home caregivers.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which revision preserves the current scope?

B. Design for trained clinic staff; assess home-caregiver use as a proposed expansion.

The revision names the agreed audience and does not promote an unassessed expansion into fact.

2. Which statement accurately describes the time target?

A. Two minutes is proposed; task boundaries and the criterion basis need review.

A number can be measurable while still lacking scope, justification, and approval.

3. What best distinguishes a need from an output?

D. The need describes the user requirement; the screen layout is a design result.

A design result can address a need but does not replace the need or evidence of fulfillment.

4. Which meeting record is most accurate?

C. Clinic scope agreed; home-use assessment and setup criterion remain open.

The supplied discussion leaves two items unresolved and provides neither approval nor a failure result.

01 Conversation answers

User Needs and Design Inputs

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. user need.** Turn 2. The user need preserves the concern before the team develops a more specific requirement.
- 2. scope expansion.** Turn 4. Adding an unassessed user group expands the project scope rather than confirming the current design's suitability.
- 3. acceptance criterion.** Turn 6. The time target could become a decision criterion, but its scope and basis require review first.
- 4. use environment.** Turn 8. The use environment covers conditions such as lighting and noise that may affect the task.
- 5. user profile.** Turn 10. The user profile identifies relevant characteristics rather than assuming different audiences have equivalent capabilities or training.
- 6. design output.** Turn 12. A screen layout is a result of design work, not the underlying user requirement.
- 7. traceability.** Turn 14. Traceability links the need, requirement, design result, and supporting evidence across the development records.
- 8. requirement owner.** Turn 16. The requirement owner coordinates clarification and maintenance of the requirement without replacing specialist review.
- 9. requirements baseline.** Turn 18. The baseline is the agreed reference set, so unreviewed proposals must not silently become approved requirements.
- 10. design input.** Turn 20. The design input translates a defined need into a specified requirement that can guide and be evaluated in development.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. clinic

Lead: "The agreed setting is the outpatient clinic."

The current brief covers outpatient staff rather than the proposed home setting.

2. expansion

Engineer: "Home use is a proposed expansion."

The additional environment broadens the scope and has not been assessed.

3. criterion

Lead: "Ninety seconds is not yet an approved criterion."

The proposed time has not completed the stated approval process.

4. baseline

Engineer: "Keep the proposal separate from the current baseline."

The agreed requirements reference should not silently incorporate an unapproved proposal.

02 Briefing and language checks

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which item is the potential source of harm?

C. The accessible hot surface

The surface is the potential source, while the skin injury is a possible resulting harm.

2. What is the status of the insulating cover?

C. Proposed, with no verified control result supplied

The briefing gives a proposed control but no implementation or effectiveness evidence.

3. Why is low risk not established?

B. Neither a likelihood estimate nor a verified control result is supplied.

The supplied information does not support a complete risk conclusion or an effective-control claim.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which chain is correctly labeled?

D. Hot surface: hazard; prolonged contact: exposure situation; burn: harm.

The chain distinguishes the potential source, the exposure circumstances, and the possible injury.

2. Which sentence accurately reports the complaint history?

D. No complaints have been received; this alone does not establish the likelihood of harm.

Complaint absence alone cannot supply the missing probability or control-effectiveness evidence.

3. Which review would support a control claim for the proposed insulating cover?

C. Its implementation, effect on contact risk, and any risk introduced by the change

A proposed safeguard needs evidence that it is implemented and effective, plus assessment of consequences elsewhere in the design. A drawing, name, or complaint count alone cannot establish that.

4. Which conclusion fits the case?

D. Further evidence is needed before the stated risk conclusion is supported.

The case supplies neither a completed risk evaluation nor a verified control result.

02 Conversation answers

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. hazard.** Turn 2. The surface is the potential source of harm, whereas a burn is the resulting injury.
- 2. hazardous situation.** Turn 4. Prolonged contact describes circumstances of exposure to the hot surface rather than the injury itself.
- 3. harm.** Turn 6. Harm identifies the possible injury, not evidence that an injury has actually occurred.
- 4. probability of harm.** Turn 8. The missing likelihood assessment cannot be replaced by an empty complaint log.
- 5. severity.** Turn 10. Severity concerns the degree of possible injury and remains distinct from the probability assessment.
- 6. risk control.** Turn 12. The cover is a proposed risk-reduction measure, not yet a demonstrated solution.
- 7. newly introduced risk.** Turn 14. A design modification can create or change other risks, which must be considered alongside its intended benefit.
- 8. Residual risk.** Turn 16. Residual risk is assessed after implemented controls, not assumed from an untested proposal.
- 9. risk acceptability.** Turn 18. Acceptability depends on the established criteria and supporting evaluation, not a reassuring adjective.
- 10. objective evidence.** Turn 20. Objective evidence is verifiable support for the eventual decision, which the current record must identify and obtain.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. hazard

Engineer: "The sharp edge is the potential hazard."

The edge is the source that could cause the described injury.

2. harm

Reviewer: "The cut is the possible harm."

A cut describes the injury rather than the physical source.

3. control

Engineer: "The rounded redesign is a proposed control."

The change is intended to reduce risk but has not been assessed.

4. evidence

Reviewer: "Its effectiveness still requires evidence."

A proposed change cannot be treated as effective without supporting evaluation.

03 Briefing and language checks

Verification, Validation, and Design Review

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What has passed?

C. Twelve planned specification checks in the current package

The briefing limits the passed work to twelve specification checks in one package.

2. What has not started?

B. The separate intended-user evaluation

The intended-user evaluation is explicitly unperformed in the supplied status.

3. What does tomorrow's meeting establish now?

B. Only that a review is scheduled

Scheduling a review does not supply its conclusions or an authorization in advance.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which slide heading is supported?

A. Twelve specification checks passed; intended-user evaluation not started.

The heading retains the actual passed work and the explicitly unperformed evaluation.

2. A software revision follows the tests. What wording is best?

C. Assess the change before assuming the earlier results cover the new version.

The impact of the change determines what previous evidence remains applicable and what further work is needed.

3. A reviewer accepts ownership of an open test deviation. Which status can be recorded at that point?

B. Owner assigned; required assessment, completion evidence, and acceptance still outstanding

Assignment establishes who will do the work, not its technical conclusion, completion, acceptance, or release effect. Those require their own evidence and decisions.

4. Which conclusion may Beth report before the review?

D. The evidence package is ready for the scheduled review, with the remaining work identified.

The available facts support readiness for review but do not supply its outcome or release authorization.

03 Conversation answers

Verification, Validation, and Design Review

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. verification.** Turn 2. The specification checks confirm specified requirements, which is the verification claim supported by the case.
- 2. validation.** Turn 4. Validation concerns requirements for intended use, and the separate intended-user evaluation is still unperformed.
- 3. requirement coverage.** Turn 6. Coverage identifies the requirements actually addressed by the available evidence rather than implying universal completeness.
- 4. configuration.** Turn 8. The configuration identifies the versions and arrangement actually tested, limiting the scope of the result.
- 5. change impact.** Turn 10. A change-impact assessment examines whether a modification affects the relevance of existing evidence or requires more work.
- 6. Release authorization.** Turn 12. Release authorization is a distinct formal decision and is not supplied by a test result or meeting invitation.
- 7. evidence package.** Turn 14. The evidence package organizes the actual records supporting the review rather than relying on a dashboard color.
- 8. test deviation.** Turn 16. A deviation is a departure from the planned test, whose significance must be assessed rather than assumed.
- 9. Action closure.** Turn 18. Closure requires the agreed completion evidence and acceptance, not merely assignment of responsibility.
- 10. decision record.** Turn 20. The decision record captures the review's real conclusion and conditions after the review occurs.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. B

Lead: "Six checks passed on version B."

The evidence is explicitly tied to the supplied tested version.

2. pending

Engineer: "The intended-use evaluation remains pending."

The briefing gives no completed evaluation or successful result.

3. review

Lead: "Friday is the scheduled review."

A booked meeting identifies a review date rather than a release decision.

4. authorized

Engineer: "Release has not been authorized."

No release decision has been made in the supplied facts.

04 Briefing and language checks

Usability and Human Factors

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What was observed?

D. Three of eight participants selected the wrong status label in the simulated task.

The observation is limited to the stated participants, label, and simulated task.

2. Which wording adds a cause not established by the three wrong selections?

D. Participants selected incorrectly because they were careless.

The study records a behavior, not carelessness as its cause. Wrong selection does not by itself establish misreading, misunderstanding, inattention, or any single explanation.

3. What is the status of the larger font?

A. An untested proposed revision

The revised label has not been tested, so its effect is not established.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which summary is most accurate?

C. Three of eight participants selected the wrong label in the formative simulated task.

The accurate summary preserves the observed count and the study's scope without adding a cause or outcome.

2. A participant can read both labels aloud but confuses their meanings. Which issue is most directly suggested?

B. Label comprehension

Reading the characters while confusing their meaning points to comprehension rather than legibility alone.

3. How should assistance during a task be reported?

B. Document the prompting rather than presenting assisted success as unassisted performance.

Prompting can affect the interpretation of performance and must remain visible in the record.

4. Which next-status sentence fits the facts?

D. The larger-font revision is proposed; its effect on the observed difficulty remains untested.

The supplied facts contain a proposal but no evaluation of that revised label.

04 Conversation answers

Usability and Human Factors

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. observation note.** Turn 2. An observation note records what participants did without supplying an unsupported explanation for their behavior.
- 2. formative evaluation.** Turn 4. A formative evaluation informs design development and does not establish a population error rate or completed validation.
- 3. Legibility.** Turn 6. Legibility concerns distinguishing text or symbols, which font size may affect without resolving meaning.
- 4. label comprehension.** Turn 8. Reading text correctly while misunderstanding its meaning suggests a comprehension issue rather than only a visibility problem.
- 5. prompting.** Turn 10. Moderator prompting can influence performance and must remain visible when interpreting task completion.
- 6. visual hierarchy.** Turn 12. Visual hierarchy concerns the relative prominence and arrangement of information, beyond the size of individual characters.
- 7. design iteration.** Turn 14. A design iteration is a revised version to evaluate, not evidence that the underlying problem is resolved.
- 8. critical task.** Turn 16. Critical-task status depends on the potential harm of incorrect or omitted performance and requires the appropriate assessment.
- 9. human-factors validation.** Turn 18. The supplied exploratory study and untested revision do not establish completed human-factors validation.
- 10. root-cause analysis.** Turn 20. Root-cause analysis examines contributors to the observed difficulty rather than accepting an unsupported blame statement.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. meaning

Researcher: "Two of ten had difficulty with the label's meaning."

The participants could read the text but misunderstood what it conveyed.

2. session

Designer: "This is an observation from a formative session."

The supplied result comes from a developmental evaluation, not a population study.

3. untested

Researcher: "The new wording remains untested."

No evaluation of the proposed wording has been performed.

4. resolved

Designer: "We cannot yet claim the difficulty is resolved."

A proposed revision does not demonstrate that the observed problem has been corrected.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is the current pathway status?

B. A possible 510(k) route is being evaluated.

The briefing identifies an ongoing pathway assessment, not a completed submission or decision.

2. What is known about the predicate?

D. A candidate has been identified, but suitability remains under review.

The candidate's identification does not settle whether it supports the proposed pathway.

3. Why is the October launch promise unsupported?

B. No filing or regulatory decision exists, and the pathway assessment is incomplete.

The case supplies unresolved dependencies rather than a guaranteed launch authorization or date.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which sales-slide correction matches the case?

B. Possible 510(k) pathway under internal assessment; no submission or FDA decision yet.

The correction describes the actual internal stage without inventing approval, timing, or rejection.

2. Which statement about the candidate predicate is accurate?

D. Identification begins the assessment; suitability and the comparative evidence still need review.

A named candidate is not itself an accepted comparison or a regulatory decision.

3. Which October-launch note preserves the current regulatory status?

C. Internal planning target; pathway and predicate still under assessment, with no filing or decision

The date is internal and conditional. Neither internal approval, a candidate comparator, nor a pathway discussion starts or settles the required agency decision.

4. What does a pre-submission interaction establish by itself?

C. An opportunity for feedback, not marketing authorization

A pre-submission exchange does not itself supply the later marketing decision.

05 Conversation answers

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. regulatory pathway. Turn 2. The pathway is the route being evaluated, not an agency decision already obtained.

2. predicate device. Turn 4. A candidate predicate is a comparator under assessment, not proof that the route or outcome is settled.

3. substantial equivalence. Turn 6. Substantial equivalence is the comparative regulatory determination sought through a 510(k), not a claim established by appearance.

4. submission dossier. Turn 8. The dossier is the organized submission material, which has not yet been filed in this case.

5. clearance. Turn 10. Clearance is the appropriate favorable 510(k) decision term, distinct from PMA approval.

6. regulatory strategy. Turn 12. The strategy coordinates the applicable route and evidence; it remains subject to the unresolved assessment.

7. indications for use. Turn 14. Indications describe the specific proposed purposes and population, which must align with the regulatory assessment and evidence.

8. launch assumption. Turn 16. The October date is a conditional planning premise rather than an authorized or guaranteed launch date.

9. pre-submission interaction. Turn 18. A pre-submission interaction can provide feedback but does not itself authorize marketing.

10. marketing authorization. Turn 20. Marketing authorization is the applicable permission to market within a defined scope, which this case does not supply.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. filed

Lead: "The submission has been filed."

The facts establish submission but do not establish a favorable decision.

2. ongoing

Specialist: "The agency's review remains ongoing."

The case explicitly places the submission in an unfinished review.

3. clearance

Lead: "No 510(k) clearance has been issued."

Clearance is the relevant favorable 510(k) decision, which is not yet available.

4. assumption

Specialist: "The target date is a planning assumption."

An internal date does not guarantee the timing or outcome of regulatory review.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which time is known?

B. The call-receipt time, 14:10 today

The supplied time records receipt of the call, not the underlying event.

2. What is known about patient outcome?

D. It is not yet known.

The case supplies no outcome, so neither absence nor presence of injury is established.

3. What does eight versus four establish?

C. The complaint count doubled, but no rate can be calculated from the supplied data.

Counts can be compared directly, but a use-based rate requires a relevant denominator and context.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which intake sentence preserves the facts?

B. Display interruption reported; event date, identifier, and patient outcome unknown; call received today at 14:10.

The accurate sentence distinguishes supplied facts, unknown fields, and receipt time without inventing an outcome.

2. What is the appropriate internal handoff wording?

C. Route the available account promptly for assessment and continue documented follow-up.

Missing information should trigger follow-up rather than replace the required internal review.

3. What does the dashboard support?

D. The count rose from four to eight; the rate per use is not established.

The dashboard supplies counts, not exposure, unique-event confirmation, outcomes, or causation.

4. The caller later reports no injury. Which update preserves the information history and review responsibilities?

D. Add the attributed clarification and its receipt time; continue the applicable reporting assessment.

A later no-injury report resolves an outcome detail, not the initial knowledge state or every reporting criterion. Some malfunction circumstances can require reporting assessment even without an injury.

06 Conversation answers

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. event narrative.** Turn 2. The event narrative preserves the reported occurrence while missing facts are pursued through follow-up.
- 2. receipt date.** Turn 4. The supplied date and time concern receipt of the communication, not the unconfirmed event date.
- 3. patient outcome.** Turn 6. Patient outcome is unknown here; lack of supplied information does not establish that no injury occurred.
- 4. Unique Device Identifier.** Turn 8. The Unique Device Identifier helps identify the device, while unavailable identification details remain follow-up items.
- 5. reportability.** Turn 10. Reportability depends on applicable criteria and the event assessment, not the intake team's unsupported assumption.
- 6. follow-up attempt.** Turn 12. A follow-up attempt records efforts to obtain the information needed for the investigation and reporting assessment.
- 7. causal relationship.** Turn 14. A causal relationship is not established merely because the caller reported an event involving the device.
- 8. exposure denominator.** Turn 16. A rate relative to use requires the relevant exposure quantity, which the dashboard does not provide.
- 9. duplicate report.** Turn 18. A duplicate report may describe an already recorded event, so record counts are not automatically unique-event counts.
- 10. supplemental report.** Turn 20. A supplemental report provides required later information through the appropriate reporting process rather than silently altering history.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. received

Specialist: "Today is the date the report was received."

The case gives the communication date but not the event date.

2. unknown

Colleague: "The patient outcome is still unknown."

No outcome was supplied, so absence of injury cannot be assumed.

3. count

Specialist: "Six is the complaint count."

Six describes recorded complaints rather than a rate per use.

4. denominator

Colleague: "A use-based rate needs the exposure denominator."

The relevant number of uses is missing from the supplied data.

07 Briefing and language checks

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. How many pieces are in the two held lots?

D. 300

The held-lot quantities are 120 and 180, which total 300 pieces.

2. How many sampled pieces are explicitly reported as failing?

C. Two, one from each lot

The brief reports two observed sampled failures, not inspection results for every piece.

3. What is the current disposition?

D. Both lots remain on hold; no release or rework is authorized.

The case supplies a hold and explicitly states that disposition has not been authorized.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which quantity statement is accurate?

C. Three hundred pieces are held; two sampled pieces are explicitly reported as failing.

The statement distinguishes total held quantity from the two observed sampled failures.

2. Production proposes using the 180-piece lot because its certificate is conforming. Which response preserves the current evidence and authority?

B. The failed sample and hold remain; the certificate does not replace an authorized disposition.

The hold covers the whole lot. A certificate, missing individual results, and deadline do not supply the missing handling decision or cancel contrary inspection evidence.

3. Which statement distinguishes correction from corrective action?

C. Correction addresses the detected problem; corrective action addresses its cause to prevent recurrence.

The distinction concerns fixing the detected nonconformity versus addressing the cause of recurrence.

4. Which supplier update is best supported?

A. The cause remains open; provide relevant evidence while both lots retain their current hold status.

The supplied evidence supports an open investigation and continued stated hold, not a cause or release decision.

07 Conversation answers

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. Incoming inspection.** Turn 2. Incoming inspection produced two sampled failures; it did not establish individual results for every piece.
- 2. nonconformance.** Turn 4. The nonconformance is the failure against the specified dimensional requirement, with its observed scope documented.
- 3. certificate of conformity.** Turn 6. A certificate is a supplier statement and does not override contrary inspection evidence or the current hold.
- 4. containment.** Turn 8. Containment limits unintended use while the scope and cause are investigated; it is not a final causal conclusion.
- 5. disposition.** Turn 10. Disposition is the authorized handling decision, which has not yet been made for these lots.
- 6. release status.** Turn 12. Release status records whether use is authorized, independently of schedule pressure or a hoped-for resolution.
- 7. correction.** Turn 14. Correction addresses a detected nonconformity itself and does not necessarily resolve the underlying cause.
- 8. calibration status.** Turn 16. Calibration status is relevant measurement information to review, not automatic proof that either party caused the problem.
- 9. corrective action.** Turn 18. Corrective action addresses a cause to prevent recurrence, with evidence needed to support its effectiveness.
- 10. lot genealogy.** Turn 20. Lot genealogy links material through production and distribution, supporting assessment of any wider affected scope.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. ninety

Planner: "The held quantity is ninety."

The hold covers the whole ninety-piece lot, not just the inspected failures.

2. two

Engineer: "The stated number of failed sampled pieces is two."

Only two sampled failures are supplied in the case.

3. disposition

Planner: "The handling decision still needs authorized disposition."

No decision permitting release or rework has been made.

4. status

Engineer: "A production deadline does not change the release status."

Schedule urgency does not supply the missing authorization for material use.

08 Briefing and language checks

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What do the current session materials cover?

C. Adult outpatient use, version 4

The brief limits the internally approved session materials to adult outpatient use in version four.

2. What is missing for the requested demonstration?

C. Reviewed materials covering the requested pediatric home-use context

Neither the request nor an unchecked old slide supplies the reviewed scope for the demonstration.

3. What should Sora avoid implying?

B. That the question is improper merely because it is outside the session scope

The scenario calls for a respectful boundary, not a judgment that asking the question is itself improper.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which reply is best supported?

D. These materials cover adult outpatient use; I can route your pediatric home-use question for a reviewed response.

The reply respects the question while accurately limiting the current materials and offering a review route.

2. How should Sora handle the version 3 slide?

D. Check its status against the controlled source before using it.

The folder copy has unverified status and cannot establish that the content is current.

3. The attendance sheet is complete after the session. What does that establish?

A. Recorded participation in this session, not performance against competency criteria

Attendance records presence. Competence needs the defined assessment, while expanded-use authorization is a separate question that a signature or discussion cannot establish.

4. Which follow-up commitment is appropriate?

C. I will route the exact question and confirm the next communication through the designated process.

The trainer can commit to routing and communication without promising an unsupported substantive outcome.

08 Conversation answers

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. training scope. Turn 2. The session scope is adult outpatient use and does not include the requested population and setting.

2. escalation route. Turn 4. The escalation route directs a question beyond the trainer's materials to the appropriate review process.

3. version control. Turn 6. Version control requires checking the valid controlled source rather than trusting an older file's presence.

4. approved material. Turn 8. Approved material means content authorized through the relevant internal process, not an expanded regulatory permission.

5. disclaimer. Turn 10. A disclaimer does not supply the missing reviewed content or make an unsupported demonstration appropriate.

6. unsolicited question. Turn 12. The clinician initiated the question; recording it does not imply that asking it was improper.

7. medical information request. Turn 14. The request preserves the exact population and setting for an appropriate reviewed response.

8. attendance record. Turn 16. An attendance record documents participation, not proof of competence across uses or clinical authority.

9. competency assessment. Turn 18. A competency assessment evaluates defined knowledge or performance criteria beyond mere attendance.

10. follow-up commitment. Turn 20. The commitment concerns routing and communication, not a guaranteed substantive answer or authorization.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. clinic

Trainer: "Today's approved materials cover adult clinic use."

The session scope is adult clinic use, not the requested home context.

2. home

Participant: "My question concerns pediatric use at home."

The requested setting must remain explicit in the handoff.

3. response

Trainer: "I will route the exact request for a reviewed response."

Routing seeks an appropriate response without inventing content in the session.

4. authorized

Participant: "That does not mean the requested use is already authorized."

A question or referral does not itself create authorization for the requested use.

08

09 Conversation answers

A small software patch still needs an impact assessment

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. change-impact assessment. Turn 2. The change-impact assessment examines the consequences of the modification, including affected functions, risks, evidence, and regulatory questions.

2. regression testing. Turn 6. Regression testing examines whether the change adversely affects behavior that should still work, beyond the targeted defect correction.

3. configuration baseline. Turn 8. The configuration baseline identifies the controlled hardware and software versions to which the evidence applies.

4. submission assessment. Turn 10. The submission assessment determines the regulatory implications of the actual change; its outcome is not established by calling the change a bug fix.

5. deployment plan. Turn 12. The deployment plan defines the authorized update process, affected configurations, communication, and confirmation of implementation.

6. recovery procedure. Turn 16. The recovery procedure defines the assessed response to an unsuccessful update; it must not be improvised by customers or support staff.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. version

Engineer: These results identify build 4.1, not the modified version.

The test evidence applies to the identified build rather than automatically covering its successor.

2. change

Manager: Assess which conclusions remain applicable after the change.

The modification needs an impact assessment before earlier conclusions are reused.

3. package

Engineer: Keep the open work visible in the review package.

The package should show the unfinished assessment instead of implying complete evidence.

4. recorded

Manager: Do not communicate release until the authorized decision is recorded.

A release claim requires the actual authorized decision, not an assumed dashboard status.

Background reading: [FDA: Software Changes to an Existing Device](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

A field notice reaches the hospital, but not every affected unit

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. affected population. Turn 2. The affected population is the set of devices within the notice's specified scope, not simply the number of customer emails sent.

2. distribution records. Turn 4. Distribution records identify where devices were supplied and support follow-up when their current locations need confirmation.

3. Acknowledgment. Turn 6. Acknowledgment confirms receipt or recognition of the communication; it does not establish that every required device action has been completed.

4. device-level reconciliation. Turn 12. Device-level reconciliation accounts for each relevant device and its action status rather than relying on a customer-level email total.

5. effectiveness checks. Turn 16. Effectiveness checks assess whether the field communication and required response achieved their intended purpose, rather than merely counting messages.

6. closure. Turn 18. Closure is the authorized conclusion of the field action after its required evidence and conditions are satisfied.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. completion

Service lead: The reply confirms receipt, not device-level completion.

Acknowledging the notice does not show that the required action was completed for each device.

2. status

Coordinator: Obtain the required device identifiers and action status.

Device identifiers and status are needed to reconcile the potentially affected population.

3. verified

Service lead: Keep the six units pending until the evidence is verified.

The reply lacks the evidence needed to establish each unit's position.

4. plan

Coordinator: Route unresolved cases through the approved follow-up plan.

The approved plan determines the next contact and escalation steps for unresolved cases.

10

Background reading: [FDA: Recalls, Corrections and Removals for Devices](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

A new carton does not automatically preserve a sterile package

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

- 1. packaging system.** Turn 2. The packaging system includes the sterile barrier and relevant protective packaging; changing the outer configuration can affect protection.
- 2. sterile barrier.** Turn 4. The sterile barrier is the packaging that maintains the sterile condition until the intended point of use, within its established conditions.
- 3. configuration.** Turn 6. Configuration identifies the actual combination of packaging components and arrangement covered by the evidence.
- 4. package-integrity.** Turn 8. Package-integrity evidence addresses whether the barrier remains intact; a photograph alone does not establish every relevant performance requirement.
- 5. shelf-life.** Turn 10. Shelf-life evidence supports the claimed storage period under defined conditions; a packaging change does not automatically preserve or extend that support.
- 6. aseptic presentation.** Turn 14. Aseptic presentation concerns making the sterile product available at use without compromising its sterile condition, not just surviving transport.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. configuration

Engineer: The report covers the earlier packaging configuration.

The named insert is part of the tested configuration and differs from the proposal.

2. conclusion

Manager: Assess the effect of the new insert before reusing the conclusion.

The earlier conclusion cannot automatically be applied to a changed package.

3. reviewed

Engineer: Keep the change pending while the required evidence is reviewed.

The impact assessment and evidence review are incomplete, so approval is not established.

4. decision

Manager: Do not substitute components before the authorized change decision.

A proposed component replacement requires the appropriate authorized decision before implementation.

Background reading: [FDA: Recognized ISO 11607-1 Packaging Standard](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 User Needs and Design Inputs

Acknowledge the need: Ease of use matters; we need to define the task behind that phrase.

Ask about the setting: Which lighting, noise, and workflow conditions are in scope?

Keep needs visible: The requirement should address the user need rather than only our preferred feature.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

Identify the source: The accessible hot surface is the potential source of harm.

Separate two dimensions: Severity and probability answer different questions.

Request evidence: We have not yet verified the control's effectiveness.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Verification, Validation, and Design Review

State the completed work: All twelve checks in this specification package passed.

Correct the status: Replace validation complete with specification checks complete.

Describe the meeting: The review is scheduled; its conclusion is not yet available.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Usability and Human Factors

Report the observation: Three of eight participants selected the wrong status label.

Separate behavior from cause: The selection is observed; the reason still needs investigation.

Bound the percentage: That percentage describes this study group, not the user population.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

State the current stage: We are evaluating a possible 510(k) pathway.

Name the missing filing: The submission has not yet been filed.

Bound the timeline: October is a planning assumption, not an authorized launch date.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

Capture the account: The caller reported that the display stopped unexpectedly.

Preserve outcome uncertainty: Patient outcome has not been established.

Distinguish the review: Reportability needs assessment under the applicable requirements.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

State the held population: Both lots are on hold, totaling 300 pieces.

Avoid assuming conformity: The uninspected pieces are not thereby proven conforming.

Assess contrary evidence: The certificate does not erase the failed inspection result.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

Acknowledge the question: That is a specific and useful question about a different population and setting.

Decline the demonstration: I cannot improvise that demonstration within this session.

Check the source: I need to confirm the current controlled version before using that slide.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

510(k) prepare a 510(k)	41
acceptance criterion establish acceptance criteria	5
acceptance result document the acceptance result	23
acceptance sampling apply an acceptance-sampling plan	60
action closure verify action closure	24
adverse event assess an adverse event	50
affordance assess interface affordances	33
approval distinguish approval from clearance	41
approved material use current approved materials	68
attendance record maintain an attendance record	69
awareness date document the awareness date	50
benefit-risk analysis document a benefit-risk analysis	15
calibration status verify calibration status	60
CAPA assess the need for CAPA	60
causal relationship assess the causal relationship	51
certificate of conformity review the certificate of conformity	59
change impact assess change impact	24
change notification require a change notification	60
change request raise a change request	6
clearance obtain 510(k) clearance	41
close call document a close call	32
cognitive load reduce cognitive load	33
competency assessment distinguish attendance from competency assessment	69
complaint capture a complaint	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

complaint closure authorize complaint closure	51
concession evaluate a concession request	59
configuration control the test configuration	23
containment implement containment	59
contraindication identify a contraindication	68
control effectiveness verify control effectiveness	15
correction distinguish correction from corrective action	60
corrective action verify corrective action	59
critical task identify critical tasks	32
De Novo request assess a De Novo request	41
decision record maintain a decision record	24
deficiency respond to a deficiency	42
demonstration unit identify the demonstration unit	68
design assumption challenge a design assumption	6
design constraint document a design constraint	5
design input define a design input	5
design iteration evaluate a design iteration	33
design output review a design output	5
design review hold a design review	23
design transfer review design transfer	24
device classification confirm device classification	41
dimensional tolerance check dimensional tolerance	60
disclaimer avoid relying on a disclaimer alone	69
disposition approve material disposition	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

document control	maintain document control	24
duplicate report	assess duplicate reports	51
ergonomics	evaluate ergonomics	6
escalation route	follow the escalation route	69
event date	confirm the event date	50
event narrative	preserve the event narrative	51
evidence package	assemble the evidence package	24
evidence plan	develop an evidence plan	42
exposure denominator	identify the exposure denominator	51
fault condition	examine fault conditions	15
follow-up attempt	record a follow-up attempt	51
follow-up commitment	make a realistic follow-up commitment	69
foreseeable misuse	assess foreseeable misuse	15
formative evaluation	run a formative evaluation	32
general controls	comply with general controls	42
harm	describe possible harm	14
hazard	identify a hazard	14
hazardous situation	identify a hazardous situation	14
human factors	apply human-factors principles	32
human-factors validation	plan human-factors validation	32
in-service training	schedule in-service training	69
incoming inspection	perform incoming inspection	59
indication	confirm the stated indication	68
indications for use	define indications for use	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

information for safety	review information for safety	15
inherent safety	consider inherently safe design	15
initial reporter	contact the initial reporter	50
instructions for use	consult the instructions for use	68
intended use	define the intended use	5
intended user	identify intended users	5
interface	assess the user interface	6
ISO 13485	apply ISO 13485 requirements	60
label comprehension	evaluate label comprehension	33
labeling	review current labeling	68
launch assumption	qualify a launch assumption	42
legibility	assess label legibility	33
lot genealogy	trace lot genealogy	60
lot number	record the lot number	50
malfunction	investigate a reported malfunction	50
marketing authorization	confirm marketing authorization	42
measurable requirement	formulate a measurable requirement	5
measurement uncertainty	evaluate measurement uncertainty	60
Medical Device Reporting	assess Medical Device Reporting obligations	50
medical information request	route a medical information request	69
mental model	explore the user's mental model	33
moderator	brief the moderator	32
newly introduced risk	assess newly introduced risks	15
nonconformance	document a nonconformance	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

nonconforming material	control nonconforming material	59
normal condition	assess normal conditions	15
objective evidence	obtain objective evidence	15
observation note	write an observation note	33
obsolete copy	remove an obsolete copy	68
off-label use	route an off-label-use question	69
participant	recruit representative participants	32
patient outcome	clarify the patient outcome	51
postmarket surveillance	conduct postmarket surveillance	51
pre-submission interaction	request a pre-submission interaction	42
precaution	explain a precaution	68
predicate device	assess a candidate predicate	41
premarket approval	prepare a premarket approval application	41
probability of harm	estimate the probability of harm	14
product code	verify the product code	41
promotional claim	review a promotional claim	69
prompting	document moderator prompting	32
protective measure	assess a protective measure	15
Quality Management System Regulation	follow the Quality Management System Regulation	60
quarantine	place material in quarantine	59
reasonably known information	provide reasonably known information	51
receipt date	record the receipt date	50
regression testing	plan regression testing	24
regulatory dependency	identify a regulatory dependency	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

regulatory pathway assess the regulatory pathway	41
regulatory strategy align the regulatory strategy	42
release authorization obtain release authorization	24
release status verify release status	60
reportability assess reportability	50
representative sample justify the representative sample	33
representativeness justify representativeness	24
requirement coverage assess requirement coverage	23
requirement owner assign a requirement owner	6
requirements baseline approve a requirements baseline	6
residual risk evaluate residual risk	14
response package compile a response package	42
review action track review actions	24
review question address a review question	42
review quorum confirm the review quorum	24
rework authorize a rework instruction	59
risk evaluate a risk	14
risk acceptability document risk acceptability	14
risk analysis document the risk analysis	14
risk control implement a risk control	14
risk estimate justify a risk estimate	15
risk evaluation perform a risk evaluation	14
risk management file maintain the risk management file	15
root-cause analysis conduct root-cause analysis	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

safety signal investigate a safety signal	51
scope boundary state the scope boundary	69
scope expansion assess a scope expansion	6
scrap document a scrap decision	59
sequence of events map the sequence of events	14
serial number verify the serial number	50
severity assess harm severity	14
simulated use define simulated-use conditions	24
simulation conduct a training simulation	68
special controls identify special controls	42
stakeholder consult stakeholders	6
submission dossier assemble a submission dossier	42
substantial equivalence support substantial equivalence	41
summative evaluation plan a summative evaluation	32
supplemental report submit a supplemental report	51
supplier corrective action request issue a supplier corrective action request	59
supplier qualification maintain supplier qualification	60
task analysis conduct a task analysis	5
task success define task success	33
teach-back use teach-back appropriately	69
technological characteristics compare technological characteristics	41
test article identify the test article	23
test deviation assess a test deviation	23
test protocol approve a test protocol	23

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

test report	review a test report	23
traceability	maintain requirements traceability	6
traceability matrix	update the traceability matrix	23
training decay	consider training decay	33
training scope	define the training scope	68
trend analysis	perform trend analysis	51
Unique Device Identifier	capture the Unique Device Identifier	50
unresolved anomaly	review unresolved anomalies	23
unsolicited question	document an unsolicited question	69
usability engineering	conduct usability engineering	32
use difficulty	record a use difficulty	32
use environment	characterize the use environment	5
use error	analyze a use error	32
use limitation	state a use limitation	6
use scenario	map a use scenario	5
user need	capture a user need	5
user profile	develop a user profile	5
validation	plan design validation	23
verification	complete design verification	23
version control	maintain version control	68
visual hierarchy	improve the visual hierarchy	33
voice of the customer	analyze the voice of the customer	6
warning	communicate the relevant warning	68
workflow	observe the clinical workflow	6

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US FDA. Quality Management System Regulation (QMSR).

[Open the original source](#)

Current US framework, effective 2 February 2026, incorporating ISO 13485:2016. Legacy quality-system terminology should not be mistaken for the current rule. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] US FDA. Applying Human Factors and Usability Engineering to Medical Devices.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on intended users, environments, interfaces, and use-related risk. All study observations and proposed changes in this book are invented. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] US FDA. Medical Device Safety and the 510(k) Clearance Process.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on pathway distinctions and the comparative 510(k) review standard. Fictional cases do not determine a device classification or submission route. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] Electronic Code of Federal Regulations. 21 CFR 803.50.

[Open the original source](#)

US manufacturer reporting provisions, including reasonably known and missing information. Apply all relevant provisions and specialist review, not a classroom deadline. Checked 10 October 2026.

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